The Noble Great Vehicle Sūtra Called The Teaching on the Magical Display in the Domain of Skillful Means within the Bodhisattva's Sphere of Activity

Āryabodhisattvagocaropāyaviṣayavikurvaṇanirdeśanāmamahāyānasūtra · Toh 146 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་བྱང་ཆུབ་སེམས་དཔའ་སེམས་དཔའི་སྤྱོད་ཡུལ་གྱི་ཐབས་ཀྱི་ཡིད་ལ་རྣམ་པར་འཕྲུལ་པ་བསྟན་པ་ཞེས་བྱ་ཐེག་པ་ཆེན་པོའོ་ཞེས་བྱ་བ་

The Teaching on the Magical Display in the Domain of Skillful Means within the Bodhisattva's Sphere of Activity, known in Sanskrit as the Ārya Bodhisattvagocaropāyaviṣayavikurvaṇanirdeśa and in Tibetan as Phakpa Jangchup Sempé Chöyul gyi Tabkyi Yul la Nampar Trulpa Tenpa, is a Great Vehicle sūtra found as Toh 146 in the Kangyur, in its General Sūtra section. Set in the pleasure garden of King Caṇḍa Pradyota at Ujjayinī, it tells how the Nirgrantha teacher Satyavādin, a master of debate, is invited before the king and engages with the Buddha and Mañjuśrī, and through this frame it presents the perfections, the skillful means of bodhisattvas, the ideals of righteous kingship, and the teaching that all vehicles are in truth a single vehicle. It closes with prophecies of the future awakening of Satyavādin and his followers, a forecast of how the sūtra will be preserved in the time of King Aśoka, and its entrustment to Ānanda. The Tibetan translation was made by the Indian preceptor Prajñāvarman and the editor-translator Yeshé Dé.

In the language of India: ārya boṅhisatva gocara upāya biṣaya bikurbaṇa nirdeśa nāma mahāyāna sūtra

In the language of Tibet: The Noble Great Vehicle Sūtra called The Teaching on the Magical Display in the Domain of Skillful Means within the Bodhisattva's Sphere of Activity.

Homage to all the buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was dwelling in the land of Ujjayinī, in the pleasure garden of King Caṇḍa Pradyota, a supreme great forest beautifully adorned with śāla, tāla and tamāla trees, karṇikāra trees, nyagrodha, plakṣa and udumbara trees, vārṣika, dhanukari, atimuktaka and campaka trees, aśoka and pāṭalā trees. It was made lovely by many streams and ponds, lakes, lesser lakes, pools, tanks and springs, and it was filled with

blue lotuses, lotuses, white water lilies and white lotuses. It resounded with the calls of geese, cranes, peacocks, cuckoos, kunāla birds, wing-guard birds, parrots, mynas and jīvaṃjīvaka birds, it was full of many bees, and its ground was covered with fresh green grass.

There he was together with a great Saṅgha of monks, twenty thousand monks, namely the venerable Śāriputra, Mahāmaudgalyāyana, Mahākāśyapa, Aniruddha, Subhūti, Mahākātyāyana, Mahākapphiṇa, Kāla, Nanda, Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, Nadī Kāśyapa, Gayā Kāśyapa, Pūrṇa Maitrāyaṇīputra, Gavāṃpati, Vakkula, Panthaka, Cūḍapanthaka, Dravya Mallaputra, Khadiravanika, Codaka, Mahākauṣṭhila, Rāhula, and the venerable Ānanda. He was with these and the rest of the twenty thousand monks. All of them abided in the sphere of activity of the single mode of the realm of phenomena; they had entered the mode of the Dharma of essential nature, their sphere of activity being like space, without location; they abided without support; they were free of all afflictions, obscurations, fetters and entanglements; they had entered the mode in which the Tathāgata's realm of phenomena appears; they were wholly directed toward the single mode of all phenomena; they were turned toward omniscience; their path was unbroken; their minds were endowed with an unwavering devotion to omniscience; they had reached the sublime perfection of seeing wisdom and primordial wisdom clearly; and every one of them was thoroughly trained in the domain and sphere of activity of skillful means.

He was also together with eight hundred thousand nuns, such as the nun Mahāprajāpatī and Yaśodharā. All of them had thoroughly gathered the pure white qualities and fully realized the path of omniscience; they had drawn near to the primordial wisdom of omniscience; they had thoroughly realized the Dharma mode of the absence of entities and realized the Dharma mode of the absence of characteristics; they were firmly convinced that all phenomena are without limit by virtue of the limit of reality; they had attained unobstructed liberation; and every one of them was skilled in displaying forms in whatever way suited the beings to be trained.

He was also together with a great Saṅgha of bodhisattvas, seven million two hundred thousand bodhisattvas, namely the bodhisattva mahāsattvas Great Force, Holder of Great Force, Great Magical Display, King of Great Magical Display, Overpowering with Great Diligence, Hero of Great Strength, Greatly Exalted, Greatly Exalted and Mighty, Lord of the Great Host, Great Elephant the Scent Elephant, Great Moon, Excellent Moon, Moon of Qualities, Jewel Moon, All-Illuminating Moon, Moon of the Stainless Dharma, Illuminating Moon,

Renowned Moon, Moon Radiating Light Rays, Flourishing Moon, Brahmā's Voice, Voice Resounding like the Lord Brahmā, Voice Proclaiming the Grounds, Voice Proclaiming the Realm of Phenomena, Voice Overpowering All the Maṇḍalas of Māra, Voice Proclaiming the Sound of the Dharma, Voice Making Itself Understood Everywhere, Voice Unimagined through Nonconceptuality, Voice Proclaiming across the Earth, Voice Surpassing All the Limbs of Voice, Universal Essence, Essence of Qualities, Essence of the Stainless Dharma, Illuminating Essence, Ratnagarbha, Candragarbha, Sūryagarbha, Essence of Light, Padmagarbha, Essence of Lotus Glory, Essence of Merit and Glory, Essence of Wisdom and Glory, Mahāmati, Distinguished Intelligence, Renowned Intelligence, Intelligence of Great Waves, Supreme Intelligence, Jewel Intelligence, Increasing Intelligence, Infinite Intelligence, Vast Intelligence, Buddha Intelligence, Akṣayamati, Sāgaramati, Lamp of Meru, Great Lamp, Lamp of the Dharma Crystal, Lamp Filling All Directions, Universal Lamp, Lamp Dispelling All Darkness, Lamp Illuminating All Beings, Lamp of Great Radiance, Moon Lamp, Sun Lamp, Dispeller of the Lower Realms, Vanquisher of Māra, Vanquisher of the Great Māra, Hard to Emerge, Hard to Overcome, Hard to Fathom, Hard to Comprehend, Drier of the Evil Destinies, Mahāsthāmaprāpta, Avalokiteśvara, Maitreya, and the bodhisattva mahāsattva Mañjuśrī Kumārabhūta. He was with these and the rest of the seven million two hundred thousand bodhisattvas. All of them were bound to just one more birth. They had attained dhāraṇīs, attained samādhis, attained infinite eloquence, and attained unhindered fearlessness. They had reached the sublime perfection of mastery over miraculous powers. They delighted in the higher knowledges by which they travel to infinite buddha fields. They had liberated their bodies and sentient beings, and possessed the vision of primordial wisdom that is free of attachment and free of obscuration.

They displayed the appearance of buddhas in world systems where no buddha dwells. They were skilled in bringing about the distinctive attainment of the wheel of Dharma. They correctly taught the Dharma to all sentient beings, to each as was fitting. They taught the Dharma of irreversibility. They had entered the mode of the essential nature of phenomena, in which there is nothing to take up and nothing to cast aside. They spoke of emptiness. They roared the great lion's roar. They silenced all opponents and crushed all hostile māras. They had attained the conduct of bodhisattvas and all miraculous powers. They were without attachment and without anger. Their minds were like water, fire, wind and earth. They had entered the secret abode of all the

tathāgatas. They remained close to all sentient beings through the deeds of a buddha. All the tathāgatas praised them, extolled them, spoke of them in pleasing words, and honored them. They had been blessed with blessings until the eon at the final limit. They correctly upheld the Dharma modes of all the tathāgatas. They possessed the light rays of the jewel of the Dharma. They possessed the perfection of every praise of good qualities. They had become lords of the world. Their former aspirations were fulfilled. They had come forth into the sphere of activity of devotion to the Tathāgata. In the past they had practiced the Great Vehicle well. Through the mode of a buddha's primordial wisdom they were stainless and completely pure, and they were diligent in constantly and uninterruptedly making offerings to and serving the Tathāgata. They had donned the armor of irreversibility. Great compassion was manifest in them. By nature their minds were devoted to the vast. They had completely gone beyond all hesitation, doubt and indecision. Every one of them had been blessed with the blessing of the Tathāgata.

He was also together with many laymen and laywomen.

All the gods and lords of gods, nāgas and lords of nāgas, yakṣas and lords of yakṣas, gandharvas and lords of gandharvas, asuras and lords of asuras, garuḍas and lords of garuḍas, kinnaras and lords of kinnaras, mahoragas and lords of mahoragas, and humans and lords of humans, of great splendor, of great splendor, of great vastness, of great vastness, attended by many hundreds of thousands of servants and retinues, who dwell in this great trichiliocosm, assembled in that very gathering and took their seats.

At that time the Blessed One, surrounded by and facing many hundreds of thousands in the assembly, was seated upon the lion throne of the Essence of Glory. With his complexion, his splendor and the light of his body he outshone the whole assembly, and he blazed, glowed and shone.

Just as Sumeru, the king of mountains, rises high out of the ocean and, outshining the other black mountains, blazes, glows and shines, so too the Blessed One, seated on the lion throne, outshone the world with its gods and humans, and blazed, glowed and shone.

Just as the moon in the waxing fortnight, when it reaches the full, its disk complete, outshines all the constellations and the hosts of stars, dims them, and blazes, glows and shines, so too the Blessed One, seated on the lion throne, outshone the world with its gods, dimmed it, and blazed, glowed and shone.

Just as the disk of the sun, set in a pure, stainless and cloudless sky with its net of light rays streaming forth, outshines all the fireflies, dims them, and blazes, glows and shines exceedingly, so too the Blessed One, seated on the lion throne, outshone the light of Śakra (Indra), of Brahmā and of the world guardians, dimmed it, and blazed, glowed and shone.

Just as a great fire burning at night on the slope of a great mountain blazes, glows and shines, so too the Blessed One, seated on the lion throne, blazed, glowed and shone.

Just as a precious beryl jewel, endowed with eight facets, stainless and streaming with light rays, blazes, glows and shines, so too the Blessed One, seated on the lion throne and illuminating all ten directions, blazed, glowed and shone.

Just as a universal monarch outshines all the sentient beings of the four continents and blazes, glows and shines, so too the Blessed One, seated on the lion throne, blazed, glowed and shone.

Just as Śakra, lord of the gods, wearing the precious jewel called Śakrābhilagna and dwelling in Sudharmā, the assembly hall of the gods, outshines all the gods and blazes, glows and shines, so too the Blessed One, seated on the lion throne, outshone the world with its gods, and blazed, glowed and shone.

Then Mañjuśrī Kumārabhūta, aware that such a great assembly had gathered, and seeing the body of the Tathāgata, so hard to approach, thought, "In this way the Blessed One, seated on the lion throne, blazes, glows and shines exceedingly, and this great assembly too has gathered. Of what, then, will this be the portent? I shall ask the Tathāgata about its meaning." Thinking this, Mañjuśrī Kumārabhūta then rose from his seat, draped his upper robe over one shoulder, placed his right knee on the ground, bowed with palms joined toward the Blessed One, and praised the Blessed One with these verses:

"Possessing the ten powers, you outshine
This world with its gods, and sit there radiant.
Since in the three realms of existence there is none like you,
How could there be any being who surpasses you?

"Just as Meru, the abode of the gods,
Rises high above all other mountains,
And, outshining the other mountains,

Is radiant and beautiful in every direction,

"So the Sage, possessor of good qualities,
Lord of the mountains of primordial wisdom,
Rises high above the world, outshines the whole assembly,
And sits ever radiant and beautiful.

"Just as the moon that dwells in the sky
Is not lovely in the waning fortnight,
But the glorious moon, when full and complete,
Outshines all the hosts of stars,

"So you, O Sage who possess the ten powers,
Have your own disciples, a host of stars, as your attendants;
You outshine the whole world
And refresh it with the rays of your primordial wisdom.

"O Sage, just as the disk of the sun
Outshines the whole world and shines brilliantly,
So too are you, O sun among humans:
With the light of your intelligence you outshine the whole world.

"Just as a mass of fire upon a supreme mountain
Beautifies the ten directions with its splendor,
So too the Sage, dwelling on the mountain of primordial wisdom,
Is beautiful in the ten directions.

"Just as the king of beasts, outshining
The lesser beasts, dwells there in evident beauty,
So you too, O Sage, dwelling in the midst
Of all the other tīrthikas, are beautiful.

"Just as here a universal monarch, lord of men,
Outshines all beings and is beautiful,
So too the Protector, universal monarch of the supreme Dharma,
Is beautiful in the midst of beings.

"Just as Śakra, lord of the Thirty-Three,
Outshines the gods and is evidently beautiful,
So you, the unequaled, outshine
All assemblies and are beautiful."

Then, having praised the Blessed One with these verses, Mañjuśrī Kumārabhūta joined his palms and said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, please teach to this assembly the Dharma discourse called The Teaching on the Magical Display in the Domain of Skillful Means within the Bodhisattva's Sphere of Activity, by hearing which sentient beings devoted to the vast will give rise to the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening; sentient beings devoted to the inferior will come to abide in entry into the vast; sentient beings who have given rise to the mind set on awakening will increase their focus on awakening; sentient beings engaged in the inferior will undertake great endeavors; sentient beings who have strayed from the path will enter the path of awakening; and sentient beings who have entered the path of awakening will enter the mode of the intention accomplished by the Tathāgata's primordial wisdom."

When he had made this request, the Blessed One said to Mañjuśrī Kumārabhūta, "Mañjuśrī, what the tathāgatas, the arhats, the perfectly complete buddhas teach with hidden intent is difficult for the world with its gods to have faith in, difficult to know, difficult to realize, difficult to discern, difficult to enter, and difficult to comprehend fully. Therefore those whose conduct has degenerated, whose view has degenerated, or whose moral discipline has degenerated are unable to comprehend or discern it. Those devoted to the inferior are unable to have faith in it. Those whose intentions have degenerated are unable to trust in it. Those held in the grip of evil friends are unable to enter it. Those not cared for by spiritual friends are unable to realize it. Since such a Dharma cannot even be heard without the blessing of the perfectly complete Buddha, how much less could one have faith in it? Apart from the Tathāgata's blessing, that is impossible."

Then at that time the Blessed One spoke these verses:

"You whose voice is pleasing and melodious,
Listen as I explain the meaning of what you asked me.
Inferior beings, veiled in darkness,
Cannot comprehend the sublime mode of the Dharma.

"Those who have practiced under the buddhas of the past
And have been blessed by the protectors of the world,
When they hear this sublime mode of the Dharma,
Will become free of doubt and rich in excellence.

"Those whose minds are seized by the snake of evil friends,
Who have cast aside the antidote of spiritual friends,
When they hear this precious sublime Dharma,
Alas, will heedlessly fall over a great precipice.

"Those whose minds are small, inferior and timid,
And those who lack a great superior intention,
Being without trust and with their devotion degenerated,
Will not rejoice even when they hear it.

"Those who have no faith in this supreme Dharma
Will fall into suffering for a long time.
Thinking, 'Alas, they will be harmed by sufferings,'
I felt compassion for them and did not teach it."

When he had spoken thus, Mañjuśrī Kumārabhūta said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, this assembled gathering is pure. Every one of them has practiced well, has well attended and honored the buddhas who have appeared, has been well cared for by spiritual friends, has the eye of faith thoroughly purified, has come forth into the sphere of activity of devotion, has thoroughly purified intention and superior intention, and will realize the excellent aspects. Since this assembled gathering is like this, they will understand this mode of the Dharma, and since they will understand it fully, please, Blessed One, explain it well and correctly out of compassion for sentient beings." At that time he also spoke these verses:

"Great Sage, here there are many sentient beings
Endowed with glory and good qualities who will understand this Dharma.
Those who practiced well under the buddhas of the past:
To them, Lord of Sages, please teach the Dharma today.

"Since they are here with reverence, their palms joined,
Gazing at the face of the god among humans,
Great Sage, for their sake please give rise to compassion
And let the rain of the sublime Dharma fall as they would wish.

"Since I make this request of you, King of Dharma,
Please fully teach the excellent, sublime Dharma.
To gather the supreme herd of perfect bodhisattvas,
Protector, please open the treasury of the sublime Dharma."

When he had made this request, the Blessed One said to Mañjuśrī Kumārabhūta, "Mañjuśrī, excellent, excellent! Mañjuśrī, it is excellent, excellent that you thought to ask the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha about this matter. For, Mañjuśrī, you abide in direct perception of these qualities, you are free of doubt about all phenomena, and you have gone forth through the perfection of wisdom and skillful means. Mañjuśrī, you have set out for the benefit of many people. Mañjuśrī, you wish to bring light to the bodhisattvas of the future. Therefore, Mañjuśrī, listen well and carefully and keep it in mind. I shall explain to you the Dharma discourse called The Teaching on the Magical Display in the Domain of Skillful Means within the Bodhisattva's Sphere of Activity."

"Blessed One, so be it," said Mañjuśrī Kumārabhūta, and he and those bodhisattvas listened to the Blessed One. The Blessed One then said to them, "Children of good family, a son or daughter of good family who possesses twelve qualities will give rise to the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening. What are the twelve? They are as follows. By nature they are devoted to the vast and have no devotion to the inferior. By nature they possess compassion as their sphere of activity and have a pure white nature. They possess an unfeigned superior intention as their sphere of activity and are steadfast in their commitments. They have thoroughly gathered the accumulations and have practiced well. They have well attended and honored the buddhas who have appeared and have thoroughly gathered the pure white qualities. Their actions of body, speech and mind are blameless, and they have abandoned all evil actions. They have completely given up all evil friends and rely on spiritual friends. They act as they speak and do not deceive. They have a disposition to share, and are for the most part not attached to or craving for delicacies. They have been blessed with the Tathāgata's blessing and are free of the influence of Māra. Again and again they correctly engage in great compassion toward all sentient beings. They give away all their possessions and have minds free of attachment.

"Children of good family, a son or daughter of good family who possesses these twelve good qualities gives rise to the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening, namely: a beneficent mind, in order to bring happiness to all sentient beings; a compassionate mind, so as to do no evil at all; a mind of great compassion, in order to bear the burden of all sentient beings; a mind of great loving-kindness, in order to bring complete relief to all the evil destinies; a pure mind, because it wants no other vehicle; a mind free

of afflictions, in order to clear away the turbidity of the afflictions; a luminous mind, because it is luminous by nature; a mind like an illusion, because it has no substance; a mind without entity, because it is free of entities; a stable mind, because it is unmoving; an irreversible mind, because it definitively examines all phenomena; and a mind that liberates all sentient beings, because it acts just as it speaks."

Then at that time the Blessed One spoke these verses:

"Those children of the Victor who practice the conduct well,
Whose intentions are thoroughly purified by the white qualities,
Who love even their enemies, their minds moistened by compassion:
They give rise to the mind for the sake of awakening.

"Those who have cast aside the enemy that is evil friends,
Who rely on spiritual friends who show the way to awakening,
And who train their aspirations in the vehicle of awakening:
They give rise to the mind for the sake of awakening.

"Those who, while carrying out the conduct practiced in the past,
Never give rise to a weary mind,
And who possess a mind as irreversible as a vajra:
They give rise to the mind for the sake of awakening.

"Those who have loving minds toward all people,
Who wish to bring all sentient beings to happiness,
And whose intention is to abandon all evil:
They give rise to the mind for the sake of awakening.

"Those who want no good qualities of other vehicles,
Who think of the supreme qualities of vast awakening,
And who possess minds that are pure and free of afflictions:
They give rise to the mind for the sake of awakening.

"Not conceiving, in truth, even for an instant,
Of existence or of peace as either being or not being,
Seeing all beings as a face in a mirror:
This, in truth, is the mind of awakening.

"Having cast off the dust of the faults of the afflictions,
Beautiful like the stainless sky,
Delightful to see in every mode of speech and every expression:
This is called the excellent mind of awakening.

"It is the root of the dhāraṇīs, of the analytical knowledges and of the supreme conduct;
It is the source of the major marks,
The cause of a body ablaze with the excellent minor marks;
It abides as the lineage of all the qualities of a buddha."

This concludes the first chapter, the introduction.

"Mañjuśrī, a bodhisattva who abides in such good qualities, seeing correctly the twelve benefits of good qualities, should apply himself to the perfection of generosity.

"What are the twelve? They are as follows. Seeing correctly that it shows the path of the awakening mind, one should apply oneself to the perfection of generosity. Seeing correctly that it is the path for bringing about great wealth, one should apply oneself to the perfection of generosity. Seeing correctly that one will be born into a desirable family, one should apply oneself to the perfection of generosity. Seeing correctly that it will cut off avarice, one should apply oneself to the perfection of generosity. Seeing correctly that it will increase the continuity of giving, one should apply oneself to the perfection of generosity. Seeing correctly that it will close the gates of the city of the pretas, one should apply oneself to the perfection of generosity. Seeing correctly that one will extract the essence from possessions that are shared in common with many people, one should apply oneself to the perfection of generosity. Seeing correctly that one's requisites will be complete, one should apply oneself to the perfection of generosity. Seeing correctly that one will become accustomed to giving away all one's possessions, one should apply oneself to the perfection of generosity. Seeing correctly that one will have no mind that grasps at any thing, one should apply oneself to the perfection of generosity. Seeing correctly that one's own perfection of generosity will be brought to completion, one should apply oneself to the perfection of generosity. Seeing correctly that one will be engaged in accord with the Tathāgata's instruction, one should apply oneself to the perfection of generosity.

"Child of good family, the bodhisattva mahāsattva who correctly sees these twelve benefits of good qualities should apply himself to the perfection of generosity, and should dedicate that generosity to unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening."

Then at that time the Blessed One spoke these verses:

"Thinking, 'By giving vast and unequaled gifts, they will accomplish awakening,'
They give feet, hands and heads, stainless eyes, marrow and likewise bones,
And all things outer and inner, with a mind free of avarice.
Seeing the benefits to come, with vast minds, they look for nothing in return.

"'I shall be complete in excellent wealth and be born in the highest family;
The stainless path of the buddhas and good qualities will increase, and avarice will be wholly abandoned;
The powers, the perfections and so forth will be completed: this giving is praised by the Victors.'
Reflecting thus in many ways, the wise delight in giving away everything.

"Child of good family, a bodhisattva who sees these twelve good qualities should strive in the perfection of moral discipline. What are the twelve? They are as follows. Seeing that he will be held by perfect blessings, he should strive in the perfection of moral discipline. Seeing that he will enter the path of bodhisattvas, he should strive in the perfection of moral discipline. Seeing that the bonds of his afflictions will be loosened, he should strive in the perfection of moral discipline. Seeing that he will completely pass beyond all the evil destinies, he should strive in the perfection of moral discipline. Seeing that he will purify all the paths to the evil destinies, he should strive in the perfection of moral discipline. Seeing that his actions of body, speech and mind will be blameless, he should strive in the perfection of moral discipline. Seeing that he will not be criticized by the wise, he should strive in the perfection of moral discipline. Seeing that he will rely on the quality of carefulness, he should strive in the perfection of moral discipline. Seeing that he will give the gift of fearlessness to all sentient beings, he should strive in the perfection of moral discipline. Seeing that he will attain restraint of the actions of body, speech and mind, he should strive in the perfection of moral discipline. Seeing that he will accomplish all the qualities of a buddha, he should strive in the perfection of moral discipline. Seeing that he will fully purify the unsurpassed perfection of moral discipline of the Tathāgata, he should strive in the perfection of moral discipline.

"Child of good family, the bodhisattva mahāsattva who correctly sees these twelve benefits of good qualities should strive in the perfection of moral discipline, and should dedicate that moral discipline to omniscience."

Then at that time the Blessed One spoke these verses:

"'The bonds of my afflictions will be loosened,
And I shall close the gates of the evil destinies':
Having fully considered these benefits, the wise
Should guard their moral discipline as the yak guards its tail.

"'I shall follow the Buddha's instruction,
I shall always be praised by the Sugatas,
And my blessings will not be in vain':
Thinking this comes from abiding in discipline, they guard their moral discipline.

"Body and speech will be blameless,
The mind faultless, and one will practice the Dharma.
Guarded in body and guarded in speech,
One's mind will not think of evil.

"Carefulness is praised by the Sugatas,
And it has become the root of virtuous action.
In it I shall always abide with care,
And always completely abandon all carelessness.

"If I abide in the supreme perfection of moral discipline,
I shall attain the qualities of a buddha.
One should fully purify the moral discipline of a buddha:
That, the noble ones have said, is supreme discipline.

"Whoever wishes to attain those good qualities,
The bodhisattva who wishes for supreme awakening,
If he therefore guards his discipline as the yak its tail,
That wise one will swiftly attain all good qualities.

"Child of good family, furthermore, a bodhisattva mahāsattva endowed with such qualities should cultivate patience in twelve ways.

"What are the twelve? They are as follows: one should cultivate patience thinking, 'All formations are momentary'; one should cultivate patience in order not to apprehend a self; one should cultivate patience in order to protect fully both oneself and others; one should cultivate patience in order to be entirely free of agitation; one should cultivate patience in order to eliminate the latent tendencies and the entanglements; one should cultivate patience in order to abandon attachment and anger; one should cultivate patience in order to perfect the major marks and the excellent minor marks; one should

cultivate patience in order to attain birth in the world of Brahmā; one should cultivate patience in order to pass completely beyond all harm from others; one should cultivate patience in order to attain the knowledge of exhaustion and the knowledge of non-arising; one should cultivate patience in order to pass completely beyond all the domains of Māra; and one should cultivate patience through correctly seeing the immeasurable body of the Tathāgata. Child of good family, a bodhisattva mahāsattva should cultivate patience in these twelve ways, and that patience too should be fully dedicated to omniscience."

Then, at that time, the Blessed One spoke these verses:

"Alas, phenomena are momentary and unreliable;
In them no sentient being is ever found.
If one fully realizes the qualities, the dharmas,
One will abide in the qualities of the noble buddhas.

"'Having completely abandoned the two extremes,
Never doing harm to oneself or to others,
Swiftly cultivate the perfection of patience,'
So spoke the lord of great compassion.

"In order to be always free of conceptual thought,
That one, with steadfast mind, relies on patience.
Thinking, 'I shall attain the knowledge of exhaustion,'
He relies on patience to pacify the afflictions.

"Whoever wishes to accomplish the major marks, the form, and the excellent minor marks,
And to go to the abode of Brahmā,
That one, firm in diligence, relies on the power of patience.
If one delights in patience, everything comes to abundance.

"For rendering powerless the power of Māra,
There is no equal in strength to patience.
It is the source of all good qualities;
Therefore one should rely on that quality, patience.

"Child of good family, furthermore, a bodhisattva should undertake diligence with twelve kinds of vigor. What are the twelve? They are as follows: one should undertake diligence with the vigor of fully and perfectly awakening to all phenomena; one should undertake diligence with the vigor of going into the

presence of all the tathāgatas; one should undertake diligence with the vigor of making offerings to and serving all the tathāgatas; one should undertake diligence with the vigor of pleasing all the tathāgatas; one should undertake diligence with the vigor of bringing all sentient beings to full maturity; one should undertake diligence with the vigor of establishing all sentient beings in the qualities of a buddha; one should undertake diligence with the vigor of removing the ignorance of all sentient beings; one should undertake diligence with the vigor of bringing about the wisdom of a buddha for all sentient beings; one should undertake diligence with the vigor of fully purifying all buddha fields; one should undertake diligence with the vigor of never growing weary while practicing the conduct for the sake of sentient beings for eons reaching to the furthest limit of the future; one should undertake diligence with the vigor of going to all world systems in a single instant; and one should undertake diligence with the vigor of fully and perfectly awakening to unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening and turning the wheel of Dharma in all buddha fields. Child of good family, a bodhisattva mahāsattva should undertake diligence with these twelve kinds of vigor, and that diligence too should be fully dedicated to omniscience."

Then, at that time, the Blessed One spoke these verses:

"Those children of the Sage who long for supreme awakening,
Those bulls among beings, have supreme and undaunted diligence.
They go even to a hundred buddha fields,
And though they practice the conduct for a long time, they do not weary.

"Diligent in order to bring sentient beings to full maturity,
They endure suffering for many hundreds of eons.
Wishing to give peace and happiness to countless suffering people,
Those free of laziness wish their diligence never to decline.

"'I make the aspiration to purify all fields.
I shall realize all these phenomena in every aspect.
In all the hundred fields I shall turn the wheel of Dharma.
In the supreme vehicle I shall tame ten million beings.

"'Having emanated exceedingly vast fields,
In a single instant of mind I shall awaken to supreme awakening.'
The children of the Victors, who have gone to the far shore of diligence,
Display these miraculous transformations here for the sake of beings.

"Child of good family, a bodhisattva should cultivate the meditative concentrations in twelve ways. What are these twelve? They are as follows: the aspect of pacifying the afflictions, because of being utterly undisturbed; the aspect of the mind's stability, because it does not run after objects; the aspect of non-abiding, because of passing completely beyond the desire, form, and formless realms; the supramundane aspect, because of surpassing the worldly meditative attainments; the distinctive aspect, because of not being attached to them; the aspect of freedom at will, because one turns back from the meditative concentrations; the aspect of essential nature, because of being free of the perception of things; the immeasurable aspect, because of rejecting limited meditative absorption; the aspect of calm abiding, because of being utterly peaceful; the aspect of a tamed mind, because of being well trained; the aspect of firm reflection, because the senses are firmly restrained; and the aspect of skillful means, because the intention of awakening is not abandoned. It is with these that bodhisattvas cultivate meditative concentration; they are not meditators in whom pride, views, and craving predominate. Therefore bodhisattvas surpass all meditative attainments. Child of good family, a bodhisattva should cultivate the meditative concentrations in these twelve ways, and that meditative concentration too should be fully dedicated to omniscience."

Then, at that time, the Blessed One spoke these verses:

"The meditative concentration
Of those splendid bodhisattvas
Is for the pacification of all afflictions
And for the sake of being utterly undisturbed.

"They reflect firmly on the calm abiding of peace;
They never take delight in objects.
The mind that has strayed they always
Rightly and thoroughly apply to stability.

"Not abiding, they practice concentration.
In desire, in form, or in the formless,
In none of these do they abide;
They practice concentration without abiding.

"The concentration of bodhisattvas possessed of wisdom
Is declared to be beyond the world.
Therefore, through their meditative absorptions,

They surpass the śrāvakas and the world.

"Their concentration is pliant,
And they master it just as they wish.
Not wishing to be born in the desire realm,
They turn back from the concentrations.

"The concentrations of those great beings
Are superior in their aspect.
'They are not attached to them':
Therefore the Victor declared.

"Without sentient beings, the Dharma is stainless;
Their concentration is immeasurable.
Those who practice a one-sided concentration
They outshine as they practice concentration.

"Possessed of wisdom and skillful means,
They practice the irreproachable concentration.
They have abandoned every form of view;
Their sphere of activity is supremely virtuous.

"Possessed of wisdom, they do not abide in things,
Nor do they abide in the absence of things.
Having abandoned perceptions of things and of no things,
They practice concentration.

"Those splendid ones, in such a manner,
Practice an unequaled concentration.
Before it the minds of the arhats and pratyekabuddhas
Become utterly bewildered.

"Child of good family, a bodhisattva should realize the perfection of wisdom in twelve aspects. What are the twelve? They are as follows: the aspect of light, because there is no darkness or gloom of delusion; the aspect of a lamp, because it illuminates the thicket of the afflictions; the aspect of radiating the rays of wisdom, because it is free of unknowing; the aspect of a plough, because it uproots ignorance; the aspect of a hook, because it destroys the net of craving; the aspect of a vajra, because it crushes the mountain of the afflictions to dust; the aspect of the disk of the sun, because it dries up the swamp of the afflictions; the aspect of fire, because it burns the wood of birth;

the aspect of a jewel, because it brings freedom from bewilderment; the aspect of emptiness, because there is no substance; the aspect of signlessness, because there are no characteristics; and the aspect of wishlessness, because it passes completely beyond the three realms. Child of good family, a bodhisattva should realize the perfection of wisdom in these twelve aspects."

Then, at that time, the Blessed One spoke these verses:

"This noble wisdom, like light,
Always dispels the darkness of beings.
It has arisen to shine like a lamp;
It illuminates the mass of the afflictions.

"Because it removes the roots of craving and delusion,
The virtuous mind is like a plough.
It crushes the mountains of the afflictions to dust,
Like Indra's vajra against the rising asuras.

"Since by its own light wisdom is free of darkness,
The holy ones have taught that it is like a lamp.
Because it dries the foul swamp of the afflictions,
The holy ones call it like the sun in spring.

"For those sunk in the river of the afflictions,
Like a boat it rightly ferries the world across.
Since it cuts down the great tree of delusion,
It is like a sharp sword, pure and free of concepts.

"Like a precious jewel, it frees from bewilderment;
It realizes the characteristic of phenomena, the absence of things.
Empty, sovereign, and free of concepts,
It abides neither in existence nor in peace.

"It destroys hesitation, doubt, and the like,
And it is skilled in answering questions.
It alone removes the faults of saṃsāra;
It is the lamp that shows the path to nirvāṇa.

"The Moon of Sages calls it the eye;
Its character is to make things directly evident and to realize them.
With it as their companion, the stainless bodhisattvas
Practice the conduct of awakening with a mind like Tārā's."

This concludes the second chapter, the chapter teaching the perfections.

"Child of good family, a bodhisattva's skillful means should be seen in twelve domains. What are the twelve? Child of good family, here a bodhisattva abides in the domain of nirvāṇa, yet through skillful means also appears to abide in the domain of saṃsāra. He abides in the domain of solitude, yet through skillful means also appears to abide in the domain of bustling company. He abides in the domain of meditative concentration, yet through skillful means also appears to dwell in the midst of a retinue of consorts. He abides in the domain of non-formation, yet through skillful means also appears to abide in the domain of all formative activity. He abides in the domain of non-arising, yet through skillful means also appears to abide in the domain of birth, death, and transmigration. He has passed completely beyond the domain of the four māras, yet through skillful means also displays the taming of Māra. He abides in the domain of the noble ones, yet through skillful means also appears to abide in the domain of those who are not noble. He has passed completely beyond the domain of the world, yet through skillful means also appears to abide in the domain of the world. He has found the domain of wisdom, yet through skillful means also appears to abide in the domain of the extreme of unknowing. He has directly realized the domain of the true limit, yet through skillful means does not fall into the domain of the śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas. He has understood the Dharma that is without characteristics, yet through skillful means also appears to abide in the domain of bringing all sentient beings to full maturity with a body beautifully adorned and embellished with the major marks and the excellent minor marks. He has fully entered the domain of the buddhas, yet through skillful means also appears to abide in all the domains of Māra. Child of good family, the skillful means of bodhisattvas should be seen in these twelve domains."

Then, at that time, the Blessed One spoke these verses:

"This is the domain of skillful means
Of the bodhisattvas:
In whatever domain they abide,
They appear in all domains as well.

"Though they have bathed in the lake of nirvāṇa,
Through skillful means they appear in the waters of saṃsāra.
Because they have attained the intention of skillful means,
They are not stained by the faults of either.

"Having attained, in body and mind,
The supreme solitude that benefits all beings,
Like bees in a forest of flowers,
They do not mingle with the bustle of company.

"Amid a retinue of consorts, where the loud jingling of bracelets resounds,
They appear full of amorous charm;
Yet mindful of the suffering of beings, harmed in the hells and elsewhere,
They remain forever unmoved.

"Though they are always peaceful and in meditative equipoise,
They also appear in the domains of distraction.
Yet they remove the very ground of distraction:
That is their way of skillful means.

"They are free of concepts and free of formative activity,
And in them there is no fire of conceptual thought;
Yet through skillful means they appear
Possessed of elaboration, formation, and thought.

"Though they see that phenomena are without death, transmigration, and birth,
And truly endowed with non-arising,
The wise, through the wisdom of skillful means,
Display birth and death and transmigration.

"Though the steadfast have passed wholly beyond the domain of Māra
And dwell in the domain of the buddhas,
Through the skillful means of the steadfast
They appear to roam in the domain of Māra.

"Though they dwell at the head of the assembly of the noble ones,
Through skillful means they show themselves as childish.
Though they possess the power of wisdom, their miraculous displays
Are pure and governed by compassion for beings.

"The supreme emptiness of phenomena,
That nature of reality, they have realized;
And they also practice
The skillful means of complete nirvāṇa.

"Though they realize all phenomena to be without intrinsic nature,
Empty, peaceful, and without characteristics,

Through skillful means, with a body adorned with the major marks,
They also act for the benefit of beings.

"Wisdom that has declined and lacks love,
A mind without compassion, is no way to live.
Because noble wisdom and compassion
Are pure, they are held to be skillful means.

"This is the powerful skillful means
Of the great bodhisattvas.
Those noble ones abide in it
And display hundreds of miraculous transformations.

"Child of good family, in this way too the skillful means of the tathāgatas should be seen: although they fully and perfectly awaken to unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening in buddha fields made exalted by twelve kinds of essence of good qualities, they show the degeneration of the eon, show the degeneration of the times, show the degeneration of beings, show the degeneration of the afflictions, show the degeneration of the life span, show different vehicles, show buddha fields that are thoroughly afflicted, show unruly beings, show distinctions in the teaching of the Dharma, show that there is disturbance from other, non-Buddhist teachers (tīrthikas), and show the māras and the deeds of Māra. Yet none of these faults exists; all of it should be seen as the skillful means of the Tathāgata."

When he had said this, Mañjuśrī Kumārabhūta said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, please teach those twelve essences of good qualities, possessing which the buddha field where the buddhas, the blessed ones, fully and perfectly awaken comes to be like that."

The Blessed One said, "Mañjuśrī, here the buddha field where the buddhas, the blessed ones, fully and perfectly awaken possesses the essence of the eon, because it has been accomplished through the essence of good qualities. That buddha field possesses the essence of the times, because it does not pass beyond the time for practicing the Dharma. That buddha field possesses the essence of beings, because it has beings who come to understand the Dharma. That buddha field possesses the essence of a field free of affliction, because it is thoroughly pure. That buddha field possesses the essence of well-trained beings, because there are no unruly beings. That buddha field possesses the essence of the vehicle, because one goes forth through a single

vehicle. That buddha field possesses the essence of the land, because there is an abundance of goods. That buddha field possesses the essence of the teaching, because the teachings of all other, non-Buddhist teachers are not practiced. That buddha field possesses the essence of good qualities, because it is free of guile. That buddha field possesses the essence of intention and superior intention, because it has become a place where beings are by nature pure. That buddha field possesses the essence of the noble ones, because it is never without worthy recipients of giving. That buddha field possesses the essence of awakening, because the tathāgatas of the past have gone there and others follow after them. Mañjuśrī, the buddha field where the buddhas, the blessed ones, fully and perfectly awaken possesses these essences of good qualities."

This concludes the third chapter, the chapter on skill in means.

"Mañjuśrī, by this enumeration as well, you should understand in this way that for me there is no setting forth of a vehicle of the śrāvakas and of the pratyekabuddhas. Why is that? Because the Tathāgata has no differing perceptions. Mañjuśrī, if the Tathāgata taught the Great Vehicle to some beings, the vehicle of the pratyekabuddhas to some, and the vehicle of the śrāvakas to some, then the mind of the Tathāgata would be impure. It would also be an uneven mind. It would also have the fault of clinging. Great compassion would also be partial. It would also have the fault of differing perceptions. And I would also be keeping the closed fist of a teacher with regard to the Dharma.

"Mañjuśrī, all the teachings that I have taught to beings, whatever they may be, are these: inclined toward awakening for the sake of attaining the wisdom of omniscience, flowing into the Great Vehicle, accomplishing omniscience, and bringing one to arrive at a single destination. Therefore, for me there is no setting forth of separate vehicles."

Mañjuśrī said, "Blessed One, if there is no setting forth of vehicles, why has the Tathāgata said, 'This is the vehicle of the śrāvakas.'

'This is the vehicle of the pratyekabuddhas,' and 'This is the Great Vehicle,' and taught the Dharma to beings in terms of three vehicles?"

The Blessed One said, "Mañjuśrī, what is called the setting forth of vehicles is the Tathāgata's setting forth of grounds; it is not a setting forth of vehicles. It is the Tathāgata's setting forth of the characteristics of phenomena. It is the Tathāgata's setting forth of persons. It is the Tathāgata's setting forth of small

accumulations and immeasurable accumulations. Because there is no differentiation in the realm of phenomena, here there is nothing whatsoever that becomes separate vehicles.

"Mañjuśrī, that is the Tathāgata's teaching of the doors of entry. It should be seen as being like the way one learning a craft enters into its training step by step.

"Mañjuśrī, it is like this: a master of archery who has attained the supreme perfection of the art of archery teaches the art of archery to his students through various methods and various exertions, yet what is to be learned, archery, is just one. Mañjuśrī, in the same way, the Tathāgata, the skilled master archer of the Dharma, teaches that single wisdom of omniscience in three ways.

"Mañjuśrī, it is like this: a tiny flame, when it spreads, comes to have the power to burn all the way up to the conflagration at the end of the eon. Mañjuśrī, in the same way, that single light of wisdom too, when it increases step by step, bestows everything up to the great light of the Tathāgata's wisdom, because it burns away all afflictions.

"Mañjuśrī, it is like this: Sumeru, king of mountains, is free of conceptual thought, yet all the beings who come near it take on a single color, namely the color of gold. Mañjuśrī, in the same way, the unsurpassed great Sumeru of the Tathāgata's wisdom is also free of conceptual thought, yet all the beings there who gaze upon the nature of reality of the Tathāgata take on a single color, namely the color of omniscience.

"Mañjuśrī, it is like this: wherever the great precious sapphire jewel lies, all the various shapes of different colors and all the various hues that appear anywhere within the range of that great jewel take on, through the splendor of that precious jewel, a single color, namely blue. Mañjuśrī, in the same way, all the beings upon whom falls the light and radiance of the Dharma of the Tathāgata, the unsurpassed great precious sapphire jewel, take on a single color, namely the color of omniscience.

"Mañjuśrī, it is like this: many waters flow into the great ocean through different openings, and once they have flowed into it, all of them forever remain of a single taste, namely the taste of salt. Mañjuśrī, here 'the great ocean' is a term for the Tathāgata. 'Many waters flow through different openings' is a term for the śrāvakas, the pratyekabuddhas, and the bodhisattvas. 'Once they have flowed into it, all of them become of a single

taste' is a term for the single vehicle, because it is free of conceptual thought.

"Mañjuśrī, by this enumeration as well, understand it in this way: the Tathāgata's setting forth of grounds to be purified is the Tathāgata's speaking of a way of entry; it is the Tathāgata's setting forth of the Dharma; it is the Tathāgata's teaching of gradual entry into the teaching. The setting forth of persons of small accumulations and of great accumulations is a miraculous display of skillful means, a teaching of the Tathāgata's various discriminating knowledges and of entry into the conventional. Ultimately there is a single vehicle; there are not two.

"Mañjuśrī, that other, non-Buddhist practitioners and wandering ascetics appear in this buddha field should also be seen as the skillful means of the Tathāgata; it should be understood as the sovereign power of the Tathāgata's blessing. Why is that? Mañjuśrī, because the Tathāgata has utterly removed everything that opposes him, there are no adversaries at all. Mañjuśrī, even a universal monarch, who is subject to the destruction of his roots of virtue, who has attachment, who has aversion, who has delusion, who has grasping, who has latent tendencies, and who has afflictions, has no adversaries at all, and no hostile armies. Why is that? Mañjuśrī, because the universal monarch is not subject to harm. Mañjuśrī, if even a universal monarch is like that, how could there be harm, or fear of hostile armies, to the Dharma kingdom of the Tathāgata, the great monarch who turns the wheel of Dharma, who has gathered immeasurable accumulations of merit and wisdom, who has attained unceasing great compassion, who moves in the sky of the undefiled Dharma, who possesses the jewels of the seven factors of awakening, and who is by nature free of forgetfulness? That is impossible.

"Mañjuśrī, moreover, that other, non-Buddhist practitioners and wandering ascetics appear in this buddha field should also be seen as the blessing of the Tathāgata. Understand that all those children of good family abide at a single ford.

"Mañjuśrī, it is like this: in front of the lion, king of beasts, no small animals are able to stand. Mañjuśrī, in the same way, it is impossible for any other, non-Buddhist practitioners and wandering ascetics to overpower the domain of the Tathāgata, or to stand before the Tathāgata, the great lion among men who has the ten powers and has attained the four fearlessnesses, or to debate with him, except through the blessing of the Tathāgata.

"Mañjuśrī, it is like this: when the disk of the sun rises and spreads its many rays, all the fireflies lose their light, and the rays of every fire, jewel, and star no longer appear. Mañjuśrī, in the same way, when the great sun disk of the Tathāgata rises and spreads its many rays of wisdom, all other, non-Buddhist practitioners and wandering ascetics are outshone and no longer appear.

"Mañjuśrī, it is like this: wherever on the ground the lodestone, king of iron, appears, no iron stays put there, because of the lodestone's characteristic of not mingling. Mañjuśrī, in the same way, understand that in a buddha field where a buddha has appeared, none of the other, non-Buddhist practitioners and wandering ascetics move about. Why is that? Because of the characteristic of the unmixed Dharma of a buddha's appearance.

"Mañjuśrī, it is like this: wherever the wish-fulfilling jewel, king of gems, appears, no mere beads of glass appear there. Mañjuśrī, in the same way, understand that wherever the Tathāgata, the great jewel of wisdom, appears, no other, non-Buddhist practitioners and wandering ascetics appear.

"Mañjuśrī, it is like this: from a mine that yields gold of the Jambu River, no heap of rusty iron comes forth. Mañjuśrī, in the same way, in a world system where a tathāgata appears, no other, non-Buddhist practitioners and wandering ascetics appear. Mañjuśrī, by this enumeration as well, understand in this way that wherever a tathāgata appears, no other, non-Buddhist practitioners and wandering ascetics appear.

"Mañjuśrī, moreover, understand that the appearance in this buddha field of other, non-Buddhist practitioners and wandering ascetics is the inconceivable domain of the Tathāgata's blessing and skill in means. Why is that? Because all these doors of the other, non-Buddhist teachers abide in the door of inconceivable liberation. They have emerged from the perfection of wisdom. They play through skill in means. They have not given up keeping in mind the Buddha, the Dharma, and the Saṅgha. They have reached the sublime far shore in bringing beings to full maturity. They are blessed by the blessing of the Tathāgata in order to bring beings to full maturity."

When this teaching was spoken, eight thousand gods who abided in the vehicle of the śrāvakas, having heard of the single vehicle, generated the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening. Five hundred monks attained the meditative absorption called the Lamp of Gathering Fully into the Single Vehicle. Twelve hundred bodhisattvas attained acceptance of the nonarising of phenomena. This great trichiliocosm, this world system, shook in

six ways. From the sky above, a rain of divine utpala flowers, lotuses, night lilies, and white lotuses fell. Rains of divine sandalwood powder also fell at the feet of the Tathāgata. Hundreds of thousands of gods, remaining in the sky above, raised many hundreds of thousands of shouts and sounds of laughter, and waved divine garments as fans. Divine drums were also beaten. They also uttered this exclamation: "Ah! A Dharma discourse never heard before has appeared in the world! Blessed One, may this Dharma discourse remain long in Jambudvīpa!" Eight hundred nuns also placed their upper robes upon the body of the Tathāgata.

Then, at that time, in order to teach this very point at length, the Blessed One spoke these verses:

"This inconceivable domain of my skillful means,
Mañjuśrī, you should understand in this way:
Though I attained awakening in a time of essence,
I act as teacher in times such as this.

"In me there is no fault of the times;
The time of the Dharma is always near.
From me beings hear the Dharma and enter it;
The faults of beings never exist.

"Through the distinction of qualities and goods, the essence of the eon;
Stainless and completely pure, the essence of the field;
In the essence of the times I found awakening;
Therefore in me there is no turbidity at all.

"For as many koṭis of eons
As I spent accomplishing the matchless wisdom of a buddha,
For that long, after finding awakening, is my life,
And in between I do not pass into nirvāṇa.

"Nevertheless, I show the passing into nirvāṇa:
To those who perceive permanence I teach impermanence.
I also show it as though remains were left behind,
Yet my life span is reckoned to the furthest end of the future.

"My nirvāṇa is one, and one the vehicle;
My vehicle has no divisions:
In truth I teach a single vehicle.
Know this to be the domain of skillful means.

"Thinking, 'Beings of weak disposition and small aspiration
Might be frightened if they heard it all at once,'
I teach three vehicles to them;
Yet there is one vehicle, and there is no second.

"Thinking, 'Through this teaching of mine they will come to devotion to the Dharma,
And likewise enter the path of the teaching,'
I teach the single vehicle in three forms.
Separate vehicles never exist at all.

"Just as one who has mastered archery
Shows that very skill in three ways,
So the Teacher, supreme among those skilled in the Dharma,
Shows the single vehicle in three forms.

"The Guide has an even mind toward all sentient beings;
In me there is never any perception of difference.
If I were to teach the Lesser Vehicle to others,
That would be the fault of stinginess in me.

"Just as the supreme precious sapphire (indranīla),
Wherever it may be placed,
Turns that whole area a single color,
And though it all turns blue, the jewel has no thought,

"So too the Guide of the World, the jewel of wisdom,
Likewise radiates light and pervades every field,
Turns all living beings a single color,
Transforms them into supreme awakening, yet has no conceptualizing mind.

"Just as when a small spark grows,
Great flames blaze up and spread,
So the spark of the fire of the śrāvakas' wisdom
Itself gives rise to the flames of a buddha's qualities.

"Just as all who come near Meru, king of mountains,
Take on a single color through its power,
So whoever comes to the one with the ten powers,
Those wise ones turn into supreme awakening.

"Just as bees, with their mouths,
Take up all sorts of things, both good and not good,

Gather them all together into one,
And transform them into honey,

"So the Wise One renowned in the world
Teaches the three vehicles,
Gathers up all that is wholesome,
And transforms it into the mark of awakening that is free of characteristics.

"A wheel-turning monarch suffers no harm;
No army exists that could contend with him.
When I hold the great kingdom of the Dharma,
There is no domain in it for the non-Buddhists (tīrthikas).

"Just as when the disk of the sun has risen,
It outshines all the fireflies with its light,
So when the disk of wisdom has risen,
The tīrthikas all become lightless.

"In whatever land a lodestone lies,
There no other kind of iron is found;
In whatever supreme field a tathāgata dwells,
There no tīrthikas appear.

"In whatever land the king of gold has appeared,
No scattered heaps of iron come forth from it;
Wherever a Guide has found awakening,
In that field no host of tīrthikas arises.

"That a wish-fulfilling jewel should meet with glass
Never truly comes to pass;
Likewise the jewel of a buddha and the tīrthikas
Never appear together in a single field.

"Know that all these who come by the door of the tīrthikas
Are skilled in meditative concentration and in mastery of the superknowledges.
Through the conduct of wisdom and skillful means, these intelligent ones
Display all manner of magical manifestations."

When they had heard of that domain of skillful means,
All the Victor's children grew radiant;
Joy arose in them, and gaining incomparable bliss,

They strewed many flowers over the Guide.

This great earth quaked in six ways,
Divine drums were beaten in the sky above,
Many koṭis of gods in the sky joined their palms,
And said to that Guide, "Excellent, excellent!"

This was the fourth chapter, the Teaching of the Single Vehicle.

At that time the Nirgrantha Satyavādin, a son of the Nirgranthas (Jain ascetics), came from the great southern region together with eight million Nirgranthas, wandering through the country, and gradually arrived at the great city of Ujjayinī.

King Caṇḍa Pradyota heard that the Nirgrantha Satyavādin was there in this way: that, accompanied by a great crowd of people who followed behind him raising a clamor and hundreds of thousands of bursts of laughter, he had come from the southern region to the city of Ujjayinī together with eight million Nirgranthas, and was surrounded by many great crowds of people and escorted in front by them. When he heard this, King Caṇḍa Pradyota felt faith in the Nirgrantha Satyavādin.

Having felt faith, he set out together with his great ministers, attendants, palace guards, retinue, townspeople, country folk and people of the provinces, his chaplains and the princes, with the fourfold army, the elephant troops, cavalry, chariots and infantry following him, and with great royal might and great royal splendor. Hundreds of thousands of full vases were carried before him; hundreds of thousands of musical instruments and cymbals were beaten and played; hundreds of thousands of conches were blown; hundreds of thousands of parasols, victory banners, flags and long pennants were raised; and the road was strewn thick with utpala, padma, kumuda and white lotus flowers, and with aśoka, bakula, tilaka and atimuktaka blossoms. Thus he went to welcome the Nirgrantha Satyavādin.

Then, when the Nirgrantha Satyavādin saw King Caṇḍa Pradyota approaching, he turned aside from the road, spread a mat at the foot of a tree, and sat down. Then King Caṇḍa Pradyota, knowing that the Nirgrantha Satyavādin was seated at the foot of the tree, got down from his elephant, went on foot, offered his greetings, and sat on his own throne with jeweled legs.

Then the Nirgrantha Satyavādin spoke warmly and pleasantly with King Caṇḍa Pradyota: "Great King, welcome! It is excellent that, possessed of such vast prosperity, you have come into the presence of śramaṇas and brahmins without losing your gentleness.

"Great King, is your kingdom free from harm? Is there no one doing it injury? Has it not declined or diminished? In your realm, has the kingdom not been harmed by ruffians, plunderers, players, thieves, bandits, brigands of the mountain passes, goatherds or rat-catchers? Great King, in your realm do the monks and brahmins live at ease, untroubled for dwellings, food, clothing and the requisites for practicing the Dharma? Great King, in your realm have the hunters, fishermen, dog-keepers, pig-sellers, butchers, snake-catchers and fowlers not been tormenting the living creatures that belong to the animal realm? Great King, surely you yourself do not, as of now, rule the kingdom improperly? Surely no thought of harming living creatures, whether two-legged, four-legged, legless or many-legged, has arisen in you? Why is that? Because, Great King, all sentient beings hold their lives dear.

"Therefore, Great King, give up killing, give up punishment, and let there be no contempt. Give up taking what is not given; be content with your own wealth, and do no harm to the wealth of others. Give up sexual misconduct; delight in your own queens, and have no desire for the wives of others. Give up lying, and let your speech be abundant and in accord with the Dharma. Give up divisive speech; let there be no words that cause discord, and bring about reconciliation. Give up harsh speech, and speak pleasant and gentle words. Give up idle talk; act just as you have spoken, and speak with restraint. Great King, do not covet the possessions of others or the wealth of others; rather, give rise to a mind that rejoices in them. Great King, be free of malice and endowed with loving-kindness, and keep the course of your mental action completely pure. Give up wrong view; look to the fruits of your own actions, and follow the correct view of the noble ones.

"Why is that? Great King, killing leads beings to hell; it leads them to birth as animals; it leads them to the world of Yama, lord of death. Then, even if they are born among humans, two ripenings come about: a short life and much illness.

"Taking what is not given leads beings to hell; it leads them to birth as animals; it leads them to the world of Yama. Then, even if they are born among humans, two ripenings come about: scant wealth, and wealth that

must be shared with others.

"Sexual misconduct leads beings to hell; it leads them to birth as animals; it leads them to the world of Yama. Then, even if they are born among humans, two ripenings come about: they have an unruly retinue, and a wife who has rivals.

"Lying leads beings to hell; it leads them to birth as animals; it leads them to the world of Yama. Then, even if they are born among humans, two ripenings come about: being much slandered and being deceived by others.

"Divisive speech leads beings to hell; it leads them to birth as animals; it leads them to the world of Yama. Then, even if they are born among humans, two ripenings come about: a retinue that is discordant, and a retinue that is bad.

"Harsh speech leads beings to hell; it leads them to birth as animals; it leads them to the world of Yama. Then, even if they are born among humans, two ripenings come about: hearing unpleasant words, and words of quarreling.

"Idle talk leads beings to hell; it leads them to birth as animals; it leads them to the world of Yama. Then, even if they are born among humans, two ripenings come about: their words are not respected, and their eloquence is unsure.

"Covetousness leads beings to hell; it leads them to birth as animals; it leads them to the world of Yama. Then, even if they are born among humans, two ripenings come about: discontent and great desire.

"Malice leads beings to hell; it leads them to birth as animals; it leads them to the world of Yama. Then, even if they are born among humans, two ripenings come about: seeking what is unbeneficial, and doing harm to others.

"Wrong view leads beings to hell; it leads them to birth as animals; it leads them to the world of Yama. Then, even if they are born among humans, two ripenings come about: they fall into bad views, and they become deceitful.

"Great King, in this way, through these ten paths of nonvirtuous action, a great and immeasurable mass of suffering comes together. Therefore, Great King, be conscientious, and contemplate impermanence often. Great King, the span of living is short. The measure of life cannot be long. One must depart to the beyond. The formations of life are unstable and shifting like a mountain torrent, and do not remain even for an instant. Therefore, Great King, act so that no roots of karmic ripening spring up, and see the fearfulness of the world beyond."

Then, in order to teach this very point at length, the Nirgrantha Satyavādin spoke these verses:

"Lord of the earth, be ever conscientious.
Careless beings fall over the precipice into hell;
Those who act carelessly go to hell;
Whoever is conscientious goes to the higher realms.

"O King, do not take life;
To all people life is exceedingly dear.
Therefore whoever wishes to guard a long life
Does not think of killing even in the depths of the mind.

"Protector of the world, always give up stealing;
By that, one gains stable wealth and prosperity.
Whoever takes the wealth of others, gathered bit by bit
With hardship for the sake of their lives, becomes poor.

"Always giving up the wives of others,
Lord of the earth, be content with your own queens.
Then your own queens will be dear to you,
And you will gain queens who have no rivals.

"Never speak false words;
O Indra among kings, keep your pledges abundantly.
One who speaks the truth goes to the abode of Indra;
Whoever speaks falsely goes to the world of Yama.

"If, wholly giving up faulty divisive words,
You reconcile koṭis of people with one another,
You will gain a noble retinue that cannot be divided,
And dying and passing from here, you will go to the higher realms.

"Lord of the earth, give up harsh speech;
Speak what is sweet and pleasing to others' ears.
By that cause, in the world beyond, you will hear
The many delightful words of the gods in the higher realms.

"Wholly giving up idle words,
You speak words that are most gentle and steady;
In the world beyond, as a lord among the gods,
You will have speech that beings respect.

"When you see the prosperity of others,
Lord of creatures, wish them well and do not crave it.
If one craves the wealth of others,
By that one comes to have wealth shared with others.

"Lord of the earth, harbor no malice;
Always have loving-kindness for sentient beings.
People possessed of malice, when they die and pass on,
Go to the Avīci hell, even if they have done good.

"Lord of men, give up wrong view;
Make yourself steadfast by seeing correctly.
If you rightly take up these virtuous dharmas,
You will rejoice in the celestial palaces of the gods.

"If you reverently honor monks and brahmins
Possessed of moral discipline, and your father and mother,
You will leave behind the great ground of the lower realms,
And finding the joy of the higher realms, you will rejoice."

Then the Nirgrantha Satyavādin, having spoken such words concerned with conscientiousness to King Caṇḍa Pradyota, sat in silence.

This was the fifth chapter, Going before the King.

Then King Caṇḍa Pradyota, greatly delighted by the words of the Nirgrantha Satyavādin, exchanged with him various words that bring joy and affection, asked whether he was free from ailments and troubles, and then said: "Brahmin, if you will give me leave to ask questions and have them answered, I would ask about a few matters."

When he had said this, the Nirgrantha Satyavādin said to King Caṇḍa Pradyota: "Great King, please ask whatever you wish. By answering each and every thing you ask, I shall satisfy your mind."

Leave having been given, King Caṇḍa Pradyota then said to the Nirgrantha Satyavādin: "Brahmin, people speak of 'creatures, creatures.' Of what dharma is this word 'creatures' a designation?"

He replied: "Great King, this word 'creatures' is a designation for the five aggregates of appropriation. If you ask what the five are, they are the aggregate of appropriation that is form, and likewise feeling, perception and formations, and the aggregate of appropriation that is consciousness. Moreover, Great King, it is by taking hold of these very five aggregates of

appropriation that the world of sentient beings and the container world are designated. Of these, the world of sentient beings is designated as comprised by the four modes of birth: birth from a womb, birth from an egg, birth from warmth and moisture, and miraculous birth. The container world is designated as comprised by the elements of earth, water, fire, wind and space."

He asked: "Brahmin, what is it that protects creatures?"

He replied: "Great King, it is the power of their own karma, and a lord."

He asked: "Brahmin, in what manner, and how, does the power of their own karma protect creatures?"

He replied: "Great King, there are sentient beings who, by the power of their own karma, are born in a place of such a kind that there is nothing claimed as 'mine' and nothing possessed, and they enjoy provisions that are neither plowed nor sown. Being wholly free of illness, enemies and great suffering, they do not quarrel with one another; as long as they live they dwell in prosperity, experiencing happiness in a land of plenty; and when their time comes, upon the breaking up of the body, they are born among the gods in a happy destiny, the world of the higher realms. Such, for example, are the beings of Uttarakuru in the north.

"There are sentient beings who, by the power of their own karma, are born at a time of such a kind that they are self-luminous, move through the sky, are sustained by joy as their food, are not born from a womb, and are long-lived, living for a long time. Such, for example, are the beings of the first eon.

"There are sentient beings who, by the power of their own karma, possess the strength produced by the causes of merit from before, and in this life they honor their fathers, honor their mothers, hold śramaṇas in esteem, hold brahmins in esteem, do what is beneficial and what is needed, serve the heads of their families, see danger in wrongdoing, give gifts, make merit, observe the fast-day vows, and dwell having rightly taken up moral discipline. Such, for example, are the beings of a good age, and for them no king is designated. Great King, it is in this way that the power of one's own karma is said to protect creatures."

He asked: "Brahmin, how is it that a lord of creatures is said to protect them?"

He replied: "Great King, kings are called the lords of creatures. They too are endowed with Dharma, and because they shine by bringing joy to creatures through moral discipline, good conduct and right practice, they are therefore

called kings.

"They in turn are of four kinds: wheel-turning monarchs, great kings, regional kings and minor kings.

"Of these, what is called a wheel-turning monarch is this: here, a certain king is a wheel-turning monarch, a kṣatriya anointed on the crown of the head, victorious to the four ends of the earth, endowed with Dharma, a Dharma king possessing the seven precious things. His seven precious things are these: the precious wheel, the precious elephant, the precious horse, the precious woman, the precious jewel, the precious householder and the precious minister. He dwells having thoroughly subdued this entire great earth, without hostile challenge, without harm, without punishment and without driving anyone by weapons, in accord with the Dharma and with impartiality."

He asked: "In what manner, and how, is he victorious to the four ends?"

He replied: "Because he holds sway over the four continents by his power."

He asked: "How is he triumphant?"

He replied: "Because no one acts against his command."

He asked: "How is he endowed with Dharma?"

He replied: "Because he himself has rightly taken up the ten virtuous paths of action and abides in them."

He asked: "How is he a Dharma king?"

He replied: "Because he establishes others in rightly taking up the ten virtuous paths of action."

He asked: "Why does he come to possess the precious wheel?"

He replied: "So that he may win victory with little effort and gain happiness."

He asked: "Why does he come to possess the precious elephant and the precious horse?"

He replied: "So that he may gain the wondrous happiness of the finest mounts."

He asked: "Why does he come to possess the precious woman?"

He replied: "So that he may gain the happiness of sporting in supreme delight, and the bliss of joy."

He asked: "Why does he come to possess the precious jewel?"

He replied: "So that he may gain the happiness of the finest provision of light."

He asked: "Why does he come to possess the precious householder?"

He replied: "So that he may gain the happiness of supreme mastery over wealth."

He asked: "Why does he come to possess the precious minister?"

He replied: "So that he may gain the happiness of being neither troubled nor wearied when he takes up his affairs."

He asked: "How does he come to dwell over the whole of this earth?"

He replied: "Because he dwells over all of it."

He asked: "How is he without hostile challenge?"

He replied: "Because there are no adversaries."

He asked: "How is he without harm?"

He replied: "Because nothing is done by force."

He asked: "How is he without punishment?"

He replied: "Because no harm is done by punishment or by weapons."

He asked: "How is he in accord with the Dharma?"

He replied: "Because he has wholly given up improper desire, aversion and delusion."

He asked: "How is he impartial?"

He replied: "Because he protects without taking sides."

He asked: "How does he come to dwell having thoroughly subdued it?"

He replied: "Because others do not rise up from their respective stations. Why is that? Great King, when a wheel-turning monarch conquers a continent, then all the minor kings who dwell there come and say to the wheel-turning monarch: 'Your Majesty, these dominions are prosperous and happy, with good harvests, and filled with many people and inhabitants. Please, Your Majesty, protect them. We too wish to be Your Majesty's attendants.' The wheel-turning monarch commands them thus: 'Therefore, lords of the lands, each of you protect your own dominions well. Protect them in accord with the Dharma, not against the Dharma; protect them impartially, not with partiality. Do not take pleasure in remaining in your provinces while acting against the Dharma or

acting improperly. In that way you too will be my followers.' A wheel-turning monarch of this kind protects creatures in this way, and the great kings, regional kings and minor kings follow him. Great King, it is in this way that a lord protects creatures."

He asked: "Brahmin, relying on what does a king endowed with Dharma protect creatures?"

He replied: "Great King, apart from the wheel-turning monarch, others rely on treatises to protect creatures. Why is that? At the time when a wheel-turning monarch protects creatures, there are no beings attached to delight in desire that is not Dharma, or overwhelmed by improper greed, or beset by false dharma. At that time, by the power of his own Dharma, that wheel-turning monarch possesses an understanding that is unobstructed in each and every duty of a king, so that all his aims are accomplished with little effort and everyone dwells in harmony; therefore he has no need of treatises. But when beings become attached to desire that is not Dharma, overwhelmed by improper greed and beset by false dharma, then the confidence of each of the kings diminishes; and so, in order to protect creatures by means of the Dharma, the great sages compose treatises."

He asked: "Brahmin, what is attachment to desire that is not Dharma?"

He replied: "Great King, it is delighting in the ten nonvirtuous paths of action."

He asked: "What is improper greed?"

He replied: "It is not being content with wealth earned by the strength of one's own hand, at the proper time, rightfully, and acquired by Dharma."

He asked: "What is being beset by false dharma?"

He replied: "It is to regard as a virtue, with a view thoroughly imbued by devotion to what was made by ignoble people in the age of strife, something that is labeled a treatise on worldly aims, that brings harm, and that is contrived to resemble the true Dharma."

He asked: "Brahmin, what is the treatise on which a king endowed with Dharma relies in protecting creatures?"

He replied: "Great King, it is a treatise in which the antidotes to improper desire, improper aversion and improper delusion are taught by way of their nature, their divisions or their benefits. Here the nature of the antidotes is this: the roots of virtue that serve as their antidotes, namely the root of virtue that

is non-attachment, the root of virtue that is non-aversion, and the root of virtue that is non-delusion. What motivates the antidotes is this: conscientiousness and compassion.

"Great King, when a king endowed with Dharma understands that his wealth and he himself are impermanent, establishes mindfulness, looks upon their drawbacks, and, longing for renunciation, makes use of his wealth and exercises the power of royal sovereignty, that is his conscientiousness.

"Abiding in that, he does not live off the fruits of wealth not yet obtained; he does not live off what has been obtained at the wrong time; even when the time has come, he does not live off it by doing harm to the poor; if a calamity of famine occurs, he acts as a refuge for the creatures; if harm from robbers, harm from enemy armies or harm of people to one another occurs, he gives proper help; he gives wealth to the poor; and he punishes the unruly properly. This is called his compassion. Great King, if he possesses these two qualities, a king endowed with Dharma is said to protect creatures properly. They are the two, conscientiousness and compassion."

He asked: "Brahmin, in what manner, and how, does a compassionate king endowed with Dharma punish the unruly?"

He replied: "Great King, a Dharma king who is endowed with Dharma and compassionate punishes the unruly while keeping mindfulness established on five points. He does so correctly, not wrongly; at the right time, not at the wrong time; meaningfully, not meaninglessly; gently, not harshly; and with love, not with hatred."

He asked: "In what manner, and how, is it said to be correctly, not wrongly?"

He replied: "It is when the person truly stands in the wrong, not when he does not stand in the wrong."

He asked: "How is it said to be at the right time, not at the wrong time?"

He replied: "It is when the king has the power to punish the unruly, not when he lacks that power."

He asked: "How is it said to be meaningfully, not meaninglessly?"

He replied: "It is when it is done in keeping with what was agreed, not when it is not done in keeping with it."

He asked: "How is it said to be gently, not harshly?"

He replied: "When it is understood that the matter can be settled merely by pointing out the fault, then, without doing harm by binding, killing and the like, he properly points out the fault; he does not leave the fault unspoken."

He asked: "How is it said to be with love, not with hatred?"

He replied: "When it is understood that the matter cannot be settled merely by pointing out the fault, then, excepting execution, destroying the sense faculties and cutting off limbs, he establishes a mind of love and a mind of compassion and acts harshly by means of harsh measures such as binding, imprisonment, beating, threatening, injuring, rebuking, restriction, banishment and confiscation of property. He does not act harshly beyond that."

He asked: "Brahmin, how is it that a king endowed with Dharma, while employing these harsh measures, keeps a mind of love and a mind of compassion established toward unruly beings as he acts harshly?"

When he had said this, the Nirgrantha Satyavādin said to King Caṇḍa Pradyota: "Great King, in order to establish this point fully, please listen to an example. Great King, it is like this: suppose a father wishes to correct an unruly son. He establishes a mind of love and a mind of compassion, and, excepting killing, destroying the sense faculties and cutting off limbs, he acts harshly by other kinds of harm. Yet no thought of abandoning him or thought of harming him arises; rather, he does it solely to turn back the wrongdoing, and he acts harshly thinking, 'I must see that faults that have not yet arisen do not arise.'

"In the same way, a king endowed with Dharma also establishes the perception of the creatures as his children. When he corrects unruly beings, then, excepting taking life, destroying the sense faculties and cutting off limbs, he acts with a mind of love and a mind of compassion; and although he acts harshly by means of harsh measures such as binding, imprisonment, beating, threatening, rebuking, restriction, banishment and confiscation of property, no thought of abandoning those beings or thought of harming them arises in him. Rather, he does it solely to turn back the wrongdoing, and he acts harshly thinking, 'Let others besides him learn from this, and let faults that have not yet arisen not arise.'"

He asked: "Brahmin, how should those unruly ones be recognized?"

He replied: "Great King, in brief you should know the unruly to be of five kinds: those who harm the king, those who harm one another, those who disobey

commands, those who live by wrong livelihood, and those who engage in wrongdoing.

"Of these, those who harm the king are those who kill him, have him killed, give him poison, steal from the treasury, do injurious deeds, seduce the queens, fail to act according to his commands, cannot keep his secrets, stir up unrest in the realm, speak insolently, or speak with defiance. Great King, you should know that these and the like are those who harm the king.

"Of these, those who harm one another are beings who attack one another's lives, or steal one another's property, or commit adultery with one another's wives, or deceive others by means of trickery, or divide friends, or quarrel with harsh words, or cheat others in their dealings with false weights and false measures, or speak unpleasantly to one another. Great King, you should know that these and the like are those who harm one another.

"Of these, those who disobey commands are the lesser kings of the realm who depend on the great king and do not act according to the king's commands. Great King, you should know that these and the like are those who disobey commands.

"Of these, those who live by wrong livelihood are beings who have no restraint, and you should know them to be butchers, bird-catchers, pig dealers, and the like.

"Of these, those who engage in wrongdoing are beings who have turned away from worldly enjoyments and come to bear the signs of renunciation, yet have become degenerate in moral discipline, degenerate in view, degenerate in conduct, and degenerate in livelihood, and who do not abide by the respective dharmas they have taken up. Great King, you should know that these are those who engage in wrongdoing."

The king said, "Brahmin, in what way and how should a Dharma-abiding king punish the unruly who harm the king?"

He replied, "Great King, they should be restrained by reprimand, or restrained by confiscation of their property, or restrained by imprisonment, banishment, and disgrace."

The king said, "How should one deal firmly with those who harm one another?"

He replied, "Great King, they should be checked by threats, by inflicting harm, by beating, by confinement in an enclosure, by rebuke, and by punishment."

The king said, "How should one deal firmly with those who disobey commands?"

He replied, "They should be checked by overpowering them and bringing them under control, without removing them from their own stations. Why is that? Great King, if they are not removed from their own stations, they will be grateful for the king's kindness and, out of fear, will obey his commands. Every other occasion for disobedience will be completely cut off, those who did not pay homage will pay homage, the sound of his good fame and verses in his praise will spread in the directions and intermediate directions, and on that basis much merit will increase as well."

The king said, "How should one deal firmly with those who live by wrong livelihood?"

He replied, "Great King, they should be restrained by threatening them and instilling fear, saying, 'From now on, if you act like this, you will be punished with this punishment and that.'"

The king said, "How should one deal firmly with those who engage in wrongdoing?"

He replied, "Great King, they should be checked by leading them toward the side of the true antidote. Great King, suppose a person is degenerate in moral discipline, or degenerate in view, or degenerate in conduct, or degenerate in livelihood. If a Saṅgha in concord has cleared the matter, examined it, and expelled him, or if, because of what he himself claims, the Saṅgha is unable to expel him, then the Dharma-abiding king should establish what is true as true and side with the venerable ones.

"If two Saṅghas fall into a dispute of discord, and accusation and inquiry arise concerning degeneration in moral discipline, or degeneration in conduct, or degeneration in view, or degeneration in livelihood, then the Dharma-abiding king, whether or not he himself is skilled in the meaning of the Dharma, should gather the śramaṇas or brahmins in that region who are counted as eminent and are skilled in the meaning of the Dharma, and settle the dispute. Having settled it in this way, he should side with whoever speaks rightly in the matter, and he should expel, or else make an example, in order to turn back those bent on wrongdoing."

The king said, "Brahmin, if the king himself becomes unruly, who should firmly punish him?"

He replied, "Great King, the king himself. If the king becomes heedless or lacking in compassion, then, relying on the power of wisdom, he should turn himself back from heedlessness and lack of compassion by these two things: the fear of ill repute and the fear of the lower realms.

"Great King, a Dharma-abiding king should go before the śramaṇas and brahmins in his own domain who are counted as eminent, who are learned, clear-minded, and possessed of knowledge, and from time to time he should ask them, 'What is virtue? What is non-virtue? What should one do so that things go well? What should one do so as not to commit evil?' And he should give them the opportunity to teach the Dharma. They in turn should teach him the ancient ways of kings, and, when he gives them the opportunity, they should point out his faults with gentle words. In this way, relying on inner strength or on outer strength, he will properly punish himself for being unruly."

The king said, "Brahmin, how should a Dharma-abiding king protect the people as they are sustained by the vessel world, their physical environment?"

He replied, "Great King, he does so by not burning, not destroying, and the like. That is to say, even when the king is angry at something that deserves his anger, it is not right for him to burn villages, or burn towns, or breach reservoirs, or tear down dwellings, or cut down fruit trees, or ruin crops, or to destroy any of those delightful places, whatever they may be, that are well laid out, well built, and well arranged. Why is that? Because those things are the common means of livelihood of other beings who are not the offenders, and those beings have done no wrong.

"Great King, the various deities who dwell in those things, in houses, monasteries, stūpas, orchards of fruit trees, and so on, will also be displeased if they are destroyed in that way.

"Great King, many kinds of creatures belonging to the animal realm also live in those things, and they too have done no wrong; so all those who do no harm would be destroyed for nothing. Therefore a Dharma-abiding king should not bring ruin upon the people as they are sustained by the vessel world.

"If he does not bring ruin upon them in this way, they are protected, and by protecting them he also benefits beings."

The king said, "Brahmin, how should a Dharma-abiding king care for the deities who dwell in the king's realm?"

He replied, "Great King, he should set out proper torma offerings and present them. In this way the Dharma-abiding king will have protected all the people, all the unruly will be punished, and there will be no wrongdoing either. On that basis much merit for the next life will increase as well."

The king said, "Brahmin, in the realm of a Dharma-abiding king, there are those who do not respect their aged father and mother, who are not dutiful to their father and not dutiful to their mother, who do not share properly with their children, wives, male and female servants, laborers, or hired workers, and who grievously oppress them with heavy work and degrading work. Among which class of the unruly should they be counted?"

He replied, "Great King, among the unruly of the class of wrong livelihood. Why is that? Because to withhold a share from beings who serve one, with whom one ought to share what is to be given, and to enjoy it alone, is a great wrong livelihood."

The king said, "Brahmin, there are those who, in front of the mendicant monks and brahmins who come and gather, speak unpleasantly with improper and coarse words, who abuse them, ridicule them and turn them away, who invite them specially and then withhold their food, or serve them food contrary to the Dharma, or strike them with sticks or stones, or beat them with their hands, or attack them with weapons. Among which class of the unruly should they be counted?"

He replied, "Great King, in the class of the unruly who engage in wrongdoing. Why is that? Because not to serve those who are worthy of service is a great wrongdoing. Great King, because of such wrongdoing the gods do not send down a steady flow of rain at the proper time. As a result the land becomes a perilous wilderness of famine, and the nonhuman beings send forth epidemics, afflictions, and contagious diseases. Beings then become stricken with epidemics, afflictions, and contagious diseases; their lifespan wanes, their wealth wanes, and their health wanes."

The king said, "Brahmin, why should a king, even with a mind full of affliction, not cut off and impair the sense organs and limbs, and not kill beings?"

He replied, "Great King, a king, even with a mind full of affliction, does not think of taking the life of one who abides in crookedness, or of separating him from his sense organs, his limbs, or his lesser limbs. Why is that? Because it is seen that, even if such a man dies through the force of his own karma, if he gives rise to a mind of anger and dies, he will be born in the lower realms, and

it becomes an enmity that follows on for a long time. For that reason the killing of beings has not been declared permissible. And since the sense organs, limbs, and lesser limbs cannot be restored, for that reason it has not been declared permissible to cut them off and impair them.

"Great King, since binding, confinement in an enclosure, and the like can be remedied, for that reason they are declared permissible. The king is the one who protects all the people. If he acted in that way, that very person would go unprotected, and so the king's protection of the people would not be complete. Great King, killing and cutting off and impairing the sense organs, limbs, and lesser limbs are grounds for the people to become wrongly disheartened, and that is not something a Dharma-abiding king does."

The king said, "Brahmin, the fruits of wealth that accumulate in the king's realm: are they to be called the king's own, or are they to be called others'?"

He replied, "Great King, they are neither his own nor others'. Why is that? Since others have produced them by the strength of their own hands, they are not his own. Since the king protects them, and they in turn ascribe their ownership to him, they are not others'."

The king said, "Brahmin, if the people, though they have wealth, will not render to the king the proper tax due on their wealth, are they to be called takers of what was not given, or not?"

He replied, "Great King, they are not. But if, while having wealth, they do not give, the wrongdoing and demerit that arise from avarice increase greatly."

The king said, "Brahmin, if, though they have wealth, they will not render the proper tax due on their wealth, and the king forcibly compels them to render it, is he to be called a taker of what was not given, or not?"

He replied, "Great King, on the analogy of earning a wage, he is not called a taker of what was not given."

The king said, "Brahmin, if the king forcibly compels a poor man to render the proper tax due on his wealth, is that to be called wrongdoing, or not?"

He replied, "Great King, in some cases it becomes wrongdoing, and in some cases it does not become wrongdoing. Great King, suppose that man has taken to spending his wealth on harlots, or on gambling, or has squandered it, or has taken to misusing it. If the king, with the intention of returning his share to him later, forcibly makes him render it, and if from then on he does not squander his wealth improperly, then the king has accomplished the aims of

both: the aim of increasing his own treasury and the aim of protecting the other man from ruin.

"But suppose that man's wealth has been burned by fire, or carried away by water, or seized by hostile kinsmen who share in the inheritance, or stolen by thieves, or has rotted in storage, or his crops have been carried off by hail, or eaten by locusts, parrots, and rats, or the rain has not fallen and they have not grown. If his wealth has been ruined in these and similar ways, it is fitting for the Dharma-abiding king to set the proper tax due on that wealth leniently. If he does not do so, then, because that man goes unprotected, it becomes wrongdoing."

"Great King, it is like this. Suppose, for example, that a certain man has invited mendicant śramaṇas and brahmins for a meal. Then, when the time comes, the food he has prepared is spoiled: it falls into filth, or is burned by fire, or is spoiled by grit, dust, or rain, or is carried off by thieves. If, for that reason, he does not give food to the śramaṇas and brahmins who have come at that time, then, since the food has become unfit to eat, or there is nothing to eat, it is not possible for him to offer it to the śramaṇas and brahmins, however much he would like to. Because he did not give it under those circumstances, he does not incur any wrongdoing. Great King, you should regard that case in the same way."

The king said, "Brahmin, with how many qualities does such a Dharma king, conscientious and compassionate in this way, come to possess the royal dharma complete in every respect?"

He replied, "Great King, with ten. They are: excellence ordained by heaven, an obedient retinue, excellence of wisdom, diligence, respect for the Dharma, skill, integrity, conduct that thoroughly understands the ways of the world, the endurance of hardship, and holding to the Dharma without error.

"Of these, a king who has excellence ordained by heaven is one who, among his ministers, his officials, his foremost captains of archers, his townspeople, and his country people, is by nature undisturbed, little troubled by harm, and free from illness.

"A king who has an obedient retinue always lives at ease, his royal tasks done with little effort, and he does not fall away from the ways of a king.

"A king who has excellence of wisdom is skilled in the means of protecting the people by the Dharma, and does not rely on others in the tasks he has to do.

"A diligent king lives in joy, free of enemies, and makes his treasury grow.

"A king who has respect for the Dharma does not neglect meritorious deeds, and he suppresses the unruly.

"A skilled king quickly fulfills his intentions, and since he does not take long to bring them to an end, he does not fail in his tasks.

"A king of integrity is one whom all people surround, and in whom all the townspeople and all the country people can place their trust.

"A king whose conduct thoroughly understands the ways of the world understands exactly as it is the difference between the obedient and the unruly, and does not cut off the doors through which wealth comes in.

"A king who endures hardship carries out his royal tasks completely and is not daunted even by suffering.

"One who holds to the Dharma without error accomplishes the path to a higher destiny and is never parted from spiritual friends.

"Great King, a Dharma king who possesses these ten qualities is a Dharma-abiding king complete in every respect."

The king said, "Brahmin, when a battle in war is imminent, how should a Dharma king who possesses the royal dharma complete in this way act firmly?"

He replied, "Great King, he should act firmly by three kinds of skillful means at three times. The three times are the first time, the middle time, and the last time.

"Of these, the skillful means of the first time are as follows. If the matter can be settled by making friends with the king or his ministers, he should win them over by friendship and so pacify the conflict. If it can be settled by conferring some benefit, he should win them over by conferring benefit and so pacify the conflict. If it can be settled by showing that he has gained many allies, and by showing the danger of their making him a still greater enemy, and the like, he should win them over by showing these two and so pacify the conflict. In this way he should apply skillful means at the first time.

"If they will not be persuaded by any of these, whether friendship, benefit, or a show of danger, the Dharma-abiding king should set up three intentions and then fight. What are the three? First, he should set his mind on protecting the people, thinking, 'If I am a Dharma-abiding king, surely I shall not be the one

who brings ruin upon the people; but would failing to turn back their ruin not be just the same?' The second is the intention to be victorious over the hostile enemy. The third is the intention to take them alive. Having set up these three intentions, he should give his orders to the fourfold army. In this way he should apply skillful means at the middle time.

"At the last time, he should array that fourfold army for battle according to the least brave, the moderately brave, and the bravest. Of these, the least brave are to be placed in front. The moderately brave are to be placed behind them. The cavalry are to be deployed behind both of these. The king himself, so that they may advance with confidence and at ease, and in order to protect the foot soldiers, should take his place with the bravest of all, behind them. When he does so, then out of a sense of shame, out of fear, to please the king's eyes, because their rear is secure, and to repay what has been done for them, they will attack with all their might and will not turn back. In this way he should apply skillful means at the last time.

"Even if a king who is skilled in means and arrays his battle well in this way kills or wounds the enemy's army, the wrongdoing and demerit for the king are slight, and it is not even certain that he will experience its result. Why is that? Because he carried out that action with compassion and with a mind that does not forsake beings. Since he performed that action giving up his own self and wealth for the sake of protecting the people, for his children and wife, and for his lineage, immeasurable merit grows greatly on that basis. Great King, when a battle in war is imminent, a Dharma-abiding king should act firmly in this way."

The king said, "Brahmin, with how many kinds of perception should a Dharma king who strives in this way to protect the people abide?"

He replied, "Great King, with eight. They are the perception of the beings who belong among his people as his children; the perception of the unruly as sick; the perception of compassion toward those who suffer; the perception of joy toward those who are happy; the perception that enemies arise from faults through their causes; the perception of protecting his friends and companions; the perception of wealth as medicine; and the perception of selflessness with regard to himself.

"Of these, to abide in the perception of the beings who belong among his people as his children means that the king, even when he sets about subduing the unruly, does so as a father corrects his son, and does not abandon his

compassionate intention.

"To abide in the perception of the unruly as sick means that, like a physician, he does not become angry at harm, and applies himself to removing faults completely.

"To abide in the perception of compassion toward those who suffer means that he sets about eliminating every harm and accomplishing what is beneficial.

"To abide in the perception of joy toward those who are happy means that he does not give rise to covetousness or envy toward the riches and possessions of others.

"To abide in the perception that enemies arise from faults through their causes means that he eliminates those causes and makes friends even with his enemies, to say nothing of other people.

"To abide in the perception of protecting his friends and companions means that his friendships are steadfast and he is a friend to all.

"To abide in the perception of wealth as medicine means that he does not use it in sexual misconduct, and makes use of his wealth without attachment.

"To abide in the perception of selflessness with regard to himself means that he seeks the Dharma, goes before śramaṇas and brahmins, and sets about earnestly practicing the Dharma that accords with it.

"Great King, a Dharma-abiding king who abides by these eight kinds of perception will see his treasury grow even through gifts alone, whereas one who is not Dharma-abiding will not see it grow in that way, even if he pursues it by every kind of trickery and deceit.

"If he abides by these eight kinds of perception, the lunar days, the stars, and every auspicious undertaking will all be favorable to him, and so those, human or nonhuman, who seek an opening against him will find none.

"If he abides by these eight kinds of perception, the rain will fall at the proper times, and so his realm will have good harvests and no famine-stricken wastes will arise. The dangers that spoil the crops, such as hail, locusts, parrots, and rats, will not arise. Savage beasts of prey will become few, and the enemies who intend to harm him will, with little effort on his part, perish, fade away, and be gone through the ill effects of the ripening of their own karma.

"Great King, a Dharma-abiding Dharma king who protects the people in this way is without fault before the upright of the world, and after his body breaks

up and he dies, he will be born among the gods in the happy destinies, in the heavenly world.

"On this it is said:

"Respectful of the Dharma and conscientious,
Benefiting the people, possessed of realm and retinue,
Fully understanding the conduct of others,
Pure and without attachment, the king is victorious.

"Brave and steadfast, endowed with diligence,
Skilled in the treatises and crafts of the world,
A king who strives and brings his work to completion
Protects the people in happiness.

"Beneficial and diligent, he speaks with certainty,
Compassionate, striving for the good of others.
When he discerns who has faults and who has virtues,
The king who benefits the people rejoices.

"All the hosts of his subjects are delighted;
He gives, acts for their benefit, and is even toward others.
A king who cares well for his army and his mounts
Will protect his kingdom long.

"Having given up killing and taking what is not given,
Others' wives and false speech,
Slander and harsh speech,
The fault of idle talk, and liquor,
Pure in livelihood, leaving behind
The kingdoms of human beings,
The king comes to dwell in the kingdom of the gods.
Therefore, O King, keep excellent moral discipline."

This concludes the sixth chapter, on the ways of kings.

Then King Caṇḍa Pradyota, delighted by the answers Satyavādin, son of the Nirgranthas, had given to his questions, spoke these words to Satyavādin, son of the Nirgranthas: "Brahmin, come here. Let us go to my palace. Why? Brahmin, I invite you, together with your retinue, to a meal."

When he had said this, Satyavādin, son of the Nirgranthas, spoke these words to King Caṇḍa Pradyota: "Excellent, Great King, excellent! You have spoken at the right time. Why? Great King, we are weary and hungry from the road.

Great King, we shall do just as you have said."

Then King Caṇḍa Pradyota sent Satyavādin, son of the Nirgranthas, ahead with his retinue, and went to his magnificently arrayed palace. When they arrived there, he placed Satyavādin, son of the Nirgranthas, on the king's seat. He also placed the remaining Nirgranthas on their respective seats and served them. Treating them as his superiors, with respect and reverence, he himself served them with his own hands, and he regaled Satyavādin, son of the Nirgranthas, and his retinue with food of a hundred flavors until they were satisfied. Having regaled and satisfied them in this way, and knowing that they had finished their meal, he set out pairs of garments worth a hundred thousand and clothed them. Having clothed them, he sat down to one side.

Then Satyavādin, son of the Nirgranthas, having finished his meal, set aside his bowl and withdrew his hands, and spoke these words to King Caṇḍa Pradyota:

"Great King, by making this gift you have, from the very start, destroyed avarice and stretched out the hand of generosity. In so doing you have dispelled nihilistic views and brought forth right view; you have followed in the footsteps of holy beings and wholly abandoned base ones; you have opened the doors to the higher realms and to liberation, and closed the doors to the lower realms; you have generated the roots of virtue and uprooted the roots of non-virtue; you have weakened the afflictions and increased the side of virtue; you have satisfied those who possess moral discipline; and you have benefited both yourself and others.

"Why is that? Great King, through giving one comes to have great wealth. Through giving what is excellent in color one comes to have a fine complexion. Through giving what is excellent in fragrance one comes to have renown. Through giving what is excellent in taste one obtains the finest requisites. Through giving what is excellent to the touch one comes to have soft hands and feet and youthful flesh. Through giving with due service, one comes to be served by one's relatives and others. Through giving with one's own hands, one obtains attendants. Through giving at the right time, one's aims are accomplished at the right time. Through giving what is suitable and pleasing, one's mind turns to pleasing enjoyments. Through giving without harming others, one obtains lasting wealth. Through giving while enduring hardship, one's retinue becomes devoted at heart. Through giving food one comes to have vigor and strength. Through giving clothing one comes to have a fine

complexion. Through giving lamps one comes to have good eyes. Through giving music one comes to have unimpaired hearing. Through giving mounts one comes to be at ease. Through giving medicine one comes to have little illness. Giving shelter is giving everything. Giving the Dharma is giving the nectar of immortality.

"Through giving up killing one comes to live long. Through giving up taking what is not given one comes to have great wealth. Through giving up sexual misconduct one comes to have a wife without rival. Through giving up lying one meets with little slander. Through giving up slander one comes to have a retinue that cannot be divided. Through giving up harsh speech one hears pleasing sounds. Through giving up idle talk one's words become dignified. Through giving up covetousness one is free of fierce desire. Through giving up malice one is free of fierce aversion. Through giving up wrong views one is free of fierce delusion. Through giving up pride one is born into a high family. Through giving up anger one becomes beautiful. Through giving up envy one comes to have great splendor. Through giving up avarice one becomes rich. And through giving in such a way that nothing is lacking, one becomes a person complete in every limb.

"Thus, by giving food one gives life, and one gives complexion, strength, happiness, and eloquence. Therefore the giver is cherished by many people and is sought out by the holy. His fame spreads everywhere. When he enters an assembly he is without fear. When his body breaks up he is born among the gods in the happy destinies, in the heavenly world. And in the end he attains freedom from rebirth.

"On this it is said:

"Whoever, with a mind of faith,
Respectfully gives food at the proper time
To those who are truly restrained
Will gain seven things in the life to come:

"Strength and life and complexion,
Happiness and eloquence;
He will always be born in the happy destinies,
And in the end he will gain freedom from further existence.

"For whatever purpose one gives,
For that very purpose it comes to be.
If one gives for the sake of happiness,

It turns into happiness itself.

"In the happiness that ripens from merit,
Things come about just as one intended:
One is born among humans and gods,
Or born in the form and formless realms.

"If one who possesses giving
Strives with wisdom
To put an end at last to suffering,
Great gnosis arises in him.

"The gods of the class of Māra
And those who engage in evil
Can never obstruct
Merit that has been well performed.

"The happy destinies, the gaining of wealth,
And freedom from further existence as the third:
Seeking these three aims,
For that reason one should give."

This concludes the seventh chapter, on inviting Satyavādin as a guest.

Then King Caṇḍa Pradyota thought, "Since all the Dharma that Satyavādin, son of the Nirgranthas, has taught accords entirely with the word of the Tathāgata, I should examine whether this Satyavādin, son of the Nirgranthas, has faith in the Tathāgata or not."

Having thought this, King Caṇḍa Pradyota spread out a very low seat, sat down before Satyavādin, son of the Nirgranthas, and spoke these words: "Brahmin, if you will give me the opportunity to ask a question and to have it answered, I would ask you one question."

When he had said this, Satyavādin, son of the Nirgranthas, spoke these words to King Caṇḍa Pradyota: "Great King, please ask now whatever you wish. By answering each thing you ask, I shall delight your heart."

Since he had given him the opportunity, King Caṇḍa Pradyota then spoke these words to Satyavādin, son of the Nirgranthas: "O Brahmin, in this world of beings, is there any being who is wise, learned, discerning, and upright, and who is nonetheless flawed?"

He replied, "Great King, there is."

The king said, "Brahmin, who is that?"

He replied, "Great King, this brahmin Varṣakāra is wise, learned, discerning, and upright. He is skilled in the lore of the stars, skilled in the manuals of sacrifice, and thoroughly trained in the rites of fire offering, recitation, and burning. He has mastered the causes of the seizing of the moon and the sun by the wolf, of falling stars, of lightning strikes, and of earthquakes, and he fully understands the causes of good harvests, famine, the destruction of the world, and the cycle of the years. Yet he is flawed."

The king said, "Brahmin, what is the flaw of the brahmin Varṣakāra?"

He replied, "Great King, the brahmin Varṣakāra delights in adultery. Great King, the wise do not consort with the wives of others.

Why is that? Great King, it is because by consorting with the wives of others one meets with a great deal of suffering in this life and in the next, and one is also reviled by the world with its gods and humans. On this it is said:

One whose habit is adultery,
Unrestrained, unruly, greedy for sense-objects,
Not content with his own wife,
Deserves the reproach of the world.
Here and beyond, he comes to suffering;
He undergoes killing, bondage, and harsh punishment;
He is born among the hell-beings;
His happiness is slight, and his mind is harmed.

The king said, "Brahmin, in this world of the classes of beings, is there anyone else who is wise, learned, discerning, and keen of mind, and yet has a flaw?"

He replied, "Great King, there is."

The king said, "Brahmin, who is that?"

He replied, "Great King, this brahmin Bharadvāja is wise, learned, discerning, and keen of mind, and skilled in conduct and discipline. Yet he too has a flaw."

The king said, "Brahmin, what is the flaw of the brahmin Bharadvāja?"

He replied, "Great King, this brahmin Bharadvāja is much given to dullness and drowsiness, and sleeps far too much. Great King, the wise do not indulge in dullness, drowsiness, and much sleep. Why is that? Great King, it is because this dullness and sleep are things that cause both worldly and

world-transcending qualities to decline, and they also become obstacles to wisdom and to abandonment. On this it is said:

Whoever is dull and drowsy and sleeps much,
That person is overcome by laziness.
What he has not attained, he will not attain,
And even what he has attained will decline.
Therefore one who wishes to attain distinction
Should give up idleness and laziness,
Dullness, drowsiness, and sleep,
Together with heedlessness."

The king said, "Brahmin, in this world of the classes of beings, is there anyone else who is wise, learned, discerning, and keen of mind, and yet has a flaw?"

He replied, "Great King, there is."

The king said, "Brahmin, who is that?"

He replied, "Great King, this young Prince Kṛṣṇa is wise, learned, discerning, and keen of mind, and endowed with great resolve. Yet he too has a flaw."

The king said, "Brahmin, what is the flaw of young Prince Kṛṣṇa?"

He replied, "Great King, the flaw of young Prince Kṛṣṇa is that he is extremely miserly. Great King, the wise are not miserly. Why is that? Great King, it is because one who has obtained abundant wealth and yet remains in miserliness has not taken the essence from his wealth. When he dies, he dies empty-handed and goes to the realm of Yama, and there he experiences the sufferings of hunger, thirst, and the like. On this it is said:

The man who has abundant wealth
Yet is overpowered by avarice
Goes empty-handed to the realm of Yama
And comes to suffer the torment of hunger.
There, tormented by hunger and thirst,
He suffers grief, cold, and other pains.
Therefore the wise, by their own understanding,
Do not let the stain of stinginess sully them."

The king said, "Brahmin, in this world of the classes of beings, is there anyone else who is wise, learned, discerning, and keen of mind, and yet has a flaw?"

He replied, "Great King, there is."

The king said, "Brahmin, who is that?"

He replied, "Great King, this young Prince Jayasena is wise, learned, discerning, and keen of mind; he has great resolve and is fearless, he is generous, and he is perfect in courage. Yet he too has a flaw."

The king said, "Brahmin, what is the flaw of young Prince Jayasena?"

He replied, "Great King, young Prince Jayasena takes life. Great King, the wise do not take life. Why is that? Great King, it is because a person who takes life will be short-lived and will go to the hells, to birth as an animal, and to the world of Yama. On this it is said:

The person who takes life
Is short-lived and has many illnesses,
And he will be born in the hells,
Where great misery prevails.
Therefore the wise, who do not want suffering
And who seek happiness in this life,
Do not take the lives of others,
But protect living creatures as they do themselves."

The king said, "Brahmin, in this world of the classes of beings, is there anyone else who is wise, learned, discerning, and keen of mind, and yet has a flaw?"

He replied, "Great King, there is."

The king said, "Brahmin, who is that?"

He replied, "Great King, this young Prince Abhaya is wise, learned, discerning, and keen of mind. Yet he too has a flaw."

The king said, "Brahmin, what is the flaw of young Prince Abhaya?"

He replied, "Great King, Prince Abhaya is far too compassionate. Great King, the wise are not excessively compassionate. Why is that? Great King, it is because if a king who possesses great sovereign power is excessively compassionate, there is no punishment in his kingdom, so it is thrown into turmoil by many wicked people, and the many harms done by bandits and thieves cannot be averted. On this it is said:

If a king is too compassionate,
His kingdom is disturbed and wearied
By the wicked, by plunderers, and by thieves;
A king must always be diligent, discerning, and attentive.

Therefore a lord of the land,
Seeing this fault, should give it up
And not be excessively compassionate,
Yet he should show compassion to creatures in distress."

The king said, "Brahmin, in this world of the classes of beings, is there anyone else who is wise, learned, discerning, and keen of mind, and yet has a flaw?"

He replied, "Great King, there is."

The king said, "Brahmin, who is that?"

He replied, "Great King, this young Prince Baladeva is wise, learned, discerning, and keen of mind. Yet he too has a flaw."

The king said, "Brahmin, what is the flaw of young Prince Baladeva?"

He replied, "Great King, young Prince Baladeva is greatly attached to liquor. Great King, the wise are not greatly attached to liquor. Why is that? Great King, it is because drinking liquor is a cause of the complete loss of mindfulness; it becomes an obstacle to the excellent virtues, and it makes great aims, both worldly and world-transcending, decline. On this it is said:

One who delights in liquor
Always acts heedlessly in all his affairs.
He is reproached by the wise,
And here and hereafter he is utterly deluded.
Therefore a wise person
Should give up his fondness for liquor.
It makes good qualities decline,
And hereafter it brings madness as well."

The king said, "Brahmin, in this world of the classes of beings, is there anyone else who is wise, learned, discerning, and keen of mind, and yet has a flaw?"

He replied, "Great King, there is."

The king said, "Brahmin, who is that?"

He replied, "Great King, this young Prince Vasudeva is wise, learned, discerning, and keen of mind; he has great resolve and is fearless, he is generous, and he is perfect in courage. Yet he too has a flaw."

The king said, "Brahmin, what is the flaw of young Prince Vasudeva?"

He replied, "Great King, young Prince Vasudeva is a great procrastinator. Great King, the wise are not great procrastinators. Why is that? Great King, it is because when one procrastinates too much and falls behind, one's aims are lost, and one's faults also become entrenched and are not quelled. Great King, that being so, the wise are not great procrastinators. On this it is said:

For a person who procrastinates too much,
All his aims come to ruin.
What he has not attained, he will not attain,
And even what he has attained will be lost.
Therefore, giving up procrastination,
The wise should apply themselves with great energy.
The fruits of the right moment are diminished,
And so the procrastinator comes to decline."

The king said, "Brahmin, in this world of the classes of beings, is there anyone else who is wise, learned, discerning, and keen of mind, and yet has a flaw?"

He replied, "Great King, there is."

The king said, "Brahmin, who is that?"

He replied, "Great King, this young Prince Mahāsena is wise, learned, discerning, keen of mind, and of great resolve. Yet he too has a flaw."

The king said, "Brahmin, what is the flaw of young Prince Mahāsena?"

He replied, "Great King, young Prince Mahāsena is excessively greedy. He is overcome by improper craving and steals the wealth of others. Great King, the wise do not have excessive craving. Why is that? Great King, it is because one who has great craving cannot be trusted by beings even in this very life, and when his body breaks up he is born in the lower realms. On this it is said:

Whoever is intent on hoarding,
And even when he gains wealth takes no pleasure in it,
Who steals the wealth of others,
That being who has improper craving
Goes to the lower realms when he dies,
And in this life creatures do not trust him.
Therefore a wise person
Gives up improper craving entirely."

The king said, "Brahmin, in this world of the classes of beings, is there anyone else who is wise, learned, discerning, and keen of mind, and yet has a flaw?"

He replied, "Great King, there is."

The king said, "Brahmin, who is that?"

He replied, "Great King, this young Prince Mahādeva is wise, learned, discerning, and keen of mind. Yet he too has a flaw."

The king said, "Brahmin, what is the flaw of young Prince Mahādeva?"

He replied, "Great King, young Prince Mahādeva is excitable, boisterous, and unsettled. Great King, the wise are not excitable. Why is that? Great King, it is because excitement is a thing that becomes an obstacle to calm abiding and insight, and it is a cause of going to the lower realms. Therefore the wise are not excitable. On this it is said:

A mind stained by excitement
Is not praised by the wise.
Even with effort it does not attain
The samādhi that brings suffering to its end; how then could it be freed?
Excitement destroys good qualities and renown,
And for that reason it should be given up.
For a person who seeks a great aim,
It does harm both here and hereafter."

The king said, "Brahmin, in this world of the classes of beings, is there anyone else who is wise, learned, discerning, and keen of mind, and yet has a flaw?"

He replied, "Great King, there is."

The king said, "Brahmin, who is that?"

He replied, "Great King, this Prasenajit, king of the land of Kosala, is wise, learned, discerning, and keen of mind. Yet he too has a flaw."

The king said, "Brahmin, what is the flaw of Prasenajit, king of the land of Kosala?"

He replied, "Great King, Prasenajit, king of the land of Kosala, eats far too much. Great King, the wise do not eat too much. Why is that? Great King, it is because one who eats too much becomes lazy, his body becomes heavy, his food is not easily digested, and his aims for this life and the next all decline. On this it is said:

The person who eats too much
Is heavy of body and lazy,

And his aims for this life and the next
Will certainly decline.
He suffers when awake,
And he suffers when lying down, and he troubles others.
Therefore eat what is wholesome and in due measure,
And keep fixed times for meals."

The king said, "Brahmin, in this world of the classes of beings, is there anyone else who is wise, learned, discerning, and keen of mind, and yet has a flaw?"

He replied, "Great King, there is."

The king said, "Brahmin, who is that?"

He replied, "Great King, you too are wise, learned, discerning, and keen of mind; you have great resolve and are fearless, you are generous, and you are perfect in strength of heart. Yet you too have a flaw."

The king said, "Brahmin, what is my flaw?"

He replied, "Great King, you are extremely fierce. Great King, you are extremely wrathful. Great King, you are extremely violent. Great King, you are extremely harsh. Great King, you are extremely rash. Great King, the wise are not extremely fierce. Why is that? Great King, it is because a king or a royal minister who is extremely fierce is disliked by many people; he is unloved even by his own father and mother, so what need is there to speak of the townspeople and the people of the countryside? Great King, that being so, the wise are not extremely fierce. Great King, the wise look far ahead to the consequences. On this it is said:

A king who has become fierce,
Who under the sway of anger disregards what truly matters,
Grieves deeply
Even his own father and mother.
What need is there to speak of other people?
How could they be pleased with him for even an instant?
Therefore the wise should earnestly
Give up anger entirely."

Then King Caṇḍa Pradyota, having heard such unpleasant things spoken about himself to his face, was disturbed with anger. Displeased and seething, he said to Satyavādin, son of the Nirgrantha, "Satyavādin, do you speak such

unpleasant things about me before an assembly such as this? For that, you deserve to be killed!" And with an angry mind he cried out, "This ascetic speaks ill of the king. Kill him!"

Then Satyavādin, son of the Nirgrantha, frightened and terrified, said to King Caṇḍa Pradyota, "Great King, do not act so rashly. Great King, please grant me safety, and please hear this request too."

The king said, "Satyavādin, I grant you safety. Say what you have to request."

He replied, "Great King, I too have a flaw."

The king said, "What is your flaw?"

He replied, "Great King, by speaking the plain truth like this in the presence of one so fierce, so wrathful, so hostile, and so rash as you, I too have spoken far too bluntly; I spoke nothing but the bare truth. Great King, the wise do not speak the plain truth at all times. Great King, the wise know what is the right time and what is not, and what is the right place and what is not. Why is that? Great King, it is because speaking the plain truth makes people unhappy and displeased, so the gentle do not praise it and foolish people become hostile. On this it is said:

One who speaks the plain truth
Without knowing when it is time to speak and when it is not
Is reproached even by the wise;
What need to speak of the rest of the world?
Therefore, even when the words are true,
The intelligent do not speak them on every occasion.
I too, here, in just this way,
Have harmed myself by speaking the truth."

This concludes the eighth chapter, the Teaching on Good Qualities and Faults.

Then King Caṇḍa Pradyota, pleased with what Satyavādin, son of the Nirgrantha, had so well explained, rejoiced in it and then asked further questions: "Brahmin, again, in this world of the classes of beings, is there any being who is learned, wise, discerning, and keen of mind, also skilled in the rules of conduct and discipline, and who has no flaw?"

He replied, "Great King, there is."

The king said, "Brahmin, who is that?"

He replied, "Great King, the ascetic Gautama, who went forth from the Śākya clan of the great Śākya kings, is without flaw, just as our Vedas declare. No flaw can be ascribed to him on account of the greatness of his family, for he was born into a family of universal monarchs. No flaw can be ascribed to him with regard to his lineage, for he was born in the lineage of the Ikṣvāku clan. No flaw can be ascribed to him on account of the greatness of his body either, for he has a body well adorned with the major marks and the excellent minor marks. No flaw can be ascribed to him with regard to his qualities, for he possesses moral discipline, the powers, the fearlessnesses, and the unique qualities of a buddha. For that reason he is without flaw.

"Great King, had the ascetic Gautama not gone forth from home into homelessness, he would certainly have become a universal monarch, victorious over the four quarters, a righteous king, a king of Dharma, possessing the seven precious things. His seven precious things would have been these: the precious wheel, the precious elephant, the precious horse, the precious jewel, the precious woman, the precious householder, and seventh, the precious minister. He would certainly also have had a full thousand sons, every one of them heroic and valiant, of supremely handsome form, crushing the armies of others, and bearing the marks of a universal monarch; this is beyond doubt.

He would certainly have become the sole sovereign ruling over this world system of four continents, dependent on no one else. He would certainly have conquered this entire great earth without harm or violence, without punishment and without driving anyone off by weapons, and would have dwelt having brought it well under his rule in accord with the Dharma and with impartiality. Yet he went forth from home into homelessness and undertook great vows and austerities. He passed six years on a single juniper berry, a single sesame seed, or a few grains of rice. Seated at the foot of the tree of awakening, he utterly defeated Māra together with his armies. Then, with wisdom joined to a single instant of mind, through his own direct knowledge he fully and perfectly awakened to all that is to be known, to be attained, to be seen, to be understood, and to be realized, whatever it may be. There is no being in the world equal to him, so how could there be anyone superior to him? The ascetic Gautama is equal to the unequalled, and he has no peer whatsoever. For that reason he is without flaw.

"Why is that? It is because the ascetic Gautama has no equal in family and lineage, no equal in the greatness of his form, and no match in the greatness

of his wisdom. For that reason he is without flaw. On this it is said:

Endowed with family, lineage, and form,
His body ablaze with the major marks,
The moon of sages is adorned
With the eighty excellent minor marks as well.
Outshining the hosts of non-Buddhists,
He practiced austerities for the long span of six years.
Having tamed even Māra,
The Sugata attained omniscience.
The Dharma in which there is no being and no life-force,
The perfect four truths of the noble ones,
He taught at Ṛṣipatana;
Therefore there is no flaw in him."

Then King Caṇḍa Pradyota said to Satyavādin, son of the Nirgrantha, "O great brahmin, what are the marks the ascetic Gautama possesses, such that he is said to have a body well adorned with the marks? What are those thirty-two marks of the Tathāgata, that great being, that lion?"

When he had said this, Satyavādin, son of the Nirgrantha, said to King Caṇḍa Pradyota, "Great King, then please listen, and I shall tell you. Great King, it is like this. The ascetic Gautama has feet that are well planted. The ascetic Gautama has the palms of his hands and the soles of his feet marked with wheels of a thousand spokes. The ascetic Gautama has hands and feet joined by webbing. The ascetic Gautama has hands and feet that are soft and youthful. The ascetic Gautama has long fingers. The ascetic Gautama has seven prominent parts. The ascetic Gautama has broad heels. The ascetic Gautama has ankles whose joints do not protrude. The ascetic Gautama has shanks like those of the eṇeya antelope. The ascetic Gautama has rounded thighs. The ascetic Gautama, while standing and without bending, has hands that reach his knees. The ascetic Gautama has the private parts withdrawn into a sheath. The ascetic Gautama has hairs that grow one by one. The ascetic Gautama has deep blue hair. The ascetic Gautama has hair that curls to the right. The ascetic Gautama has body hairs that curl upward. The ascetic Gautama has soft skin. The ascetic Gautama has skin the color of gold. The ascetic Gautama has very rounded shoulders. The ascetic Gautama has a full upper back between the shoulders. The ascetic Gautama has a large and upright body. The ascetic Gautama has a jaw like a lion's. The ascetic Gautama has forty teeth. The ascetic Gautama has close-fitting teeth. The

ascetic Gautama has even teeth. The ascetic Gautama has very white teeth. The ascetic Gautama has the supreme sense of taste. The ascetic Gautama has a very long and thin tongue. The ascetic Gautama has the voice of Brahmā. The ascetic Gautama has eyelashes like a cow's. The ascetic Gautama has deep blue eyes. The ascetic Gautama has the tuft of hair between the brows, complete in every respect.

"Great King, these are the thirty-two marks of a great being of the ascetic Gautama. Because he possesses them, the ascetic Gautama is said to have a body well adorned with the marks, and for that reason he is without flaw."

On this it is said:

The crown of his head is adorned with a beautiful protuberance;
His deep blue hair curls to the right;
His eyes, with lashes like a cow's, are like the finest blue lotus;
Therefore the Victor here has no flaw.
His voice is Brahmā's, the supreme voice of the kalaviṅka bird;
His tongue is broad and stainless like a lotus petal,
And that tongue of his can cover his whole face;
Therefore there is no being at all like him.
By that excellent mark, even a single taste
Swiftly becomes the supreme of all tastes;
Since the tongue of the Victor possesses it,
Therefore the Victor here has no flaw.
The qualities of his teeth are equal to the unequalled;
His teeth number a full forty.
Because of this, the whole world with its gods
Delights in the Sugata and is filled with wonder.
His jaw is a lion's, his lips like the finest bimba fruit;
Between his shoulders he is full beyond compare;
His shoulders are very round and beautiful;
His body is proportioned in height and breadth like a glorious tree.
His well-proportioned body is broad and finely shaped,
And he has a body that is lovely to every thinking being.
The heroic Sage has seven prominent parts;
The color of his skin is like refined gold.
His body is very soft, and its hairs curl upward;
His head, stainless, has lovely, thick, deep blue hair,
Soft and curling to the right;

Therefore there is no one equal to the Sugata.
The Sugata, standing without bending, reaches his knees;
His private parts are not visible, like those of a king of elephants;
His thighs are round, his shanks like an eṇeya antelope's;
What thinking being would not rely upon the Sugata?
The fingers of his hands and feet are joined by webbing;
His nails are copper-colored, his fingers well rounded;
His feet are arched like a conch and evenly set;
The supreme sage's heels are broad and even.
On his hands and feet are soft wheels;
The great sage has long fingers;
The soles of the lord of sages are well planted,
So that he moves on the ground with an unwavering body.
This is the host of marks of the great sage;
His body, adorned with them, is supremely beautiful.
When he sits amid his unequalled assembly,
He is like the moon set amid a multitude of stars.
The supreme body and form of that great being
Likewise shines brilliantly among all beings.
As for the stainless qualities of the Sugata,
Only the Sage himself could speak of them all.

The king said, "Brahmin, why is it said that the ascetic Gautama has marks born of a hundred merits?"

He replied, "Great King, for that reason I would like to offer an illustration in order to establish this very point. Great King, suppose that all the beings, however many there may be, comprised by the four modes of birth in a great trichiliocosm, were all taken into account and obtained human bodies, and that each of them, having obtained a human body, came to possess the merit of a universal monarch. Then the heap of merit of all those beings possessed of a universal monarch's merit, multiplied a hundredfold, is the heap of merit that produces a single pore on the body of the ascetic Gautama, and each of his pores is produced in the same way. The total heap of merit belonging to all his pores, multiplied a hundredfold, is the heap of merit that produces a single excellent minor mark on the body of the ascetic Gautama, and each excellent minor mark is produced in the same way. The total heap of merit belonging to all the excellent minor marks, multiplied a hundredfold, is the heap of merit

that produces a single mark of a great being on the body of the ascetic Gautama, and each of the thirty marks is produced in the same way. The total heap of merit belonging to the thirty marks, multiplied a hundredfold, is the heap of merit that produces the mark of a great being on the body of the ascetic Gautama, the crown protuberance. The heap of merit belonging to the crown protuberance, multiplied a hundred thousand koṭis of times, is the heap of merit that produces the Dharma conch of the ascetic Gautama.

"Because he possesses that Dharma conch, if the ascetic Gautama so wishes, then even if all the beings who dwell in endless, limitless world systems, all who are counted as beings, were to speak in all their various ways and put questions to the ascetic Gautama at one and the same time, each asking separately so that no question asked by one was asked by a second, the ascetic Gautama would grasp them all with wisdom joined to a single instant of mind, and with a single utterance would answer the questions just as those beings had asked them, and those beings would each understand in their own language. Great King, for that reason the ascetic Gautama is said to have marks born of a hundred merits and to have speech with the voice of Brahmā."

On this it is said:

Because he has the marks born of a hundred merits,
He is a treasure of merit in the world with its gods.
By being seen, by being heard, and by his smile as well,
He brings benefit to all sentient beings.
Thus, if all beings, with their own definite words,
Were many of them to put questions at one time,
He would understand them in a single instant of mind,
And with a single utterance answer each one separately.
Therefore, please know that the Guide in the world
Proclaims his speech with the voice of Brahmā.
He it is who turns the wheel of the Dharma
That brings an end to the suffering of gods and humans.

Then King Caṇḍa Pradyota questioned Satyavādin, son of the Nirgranthas, in verse:

Those things you spoke of earlier,
When you said there are excellent minor marks:
What are the Sage's excellent minor marks?
Great brahmin, please describe them.

When he had said this, Satyavādin, son of the Nirgranthas, replied to King Caṇḍa Pradyota in verse:

Those by which the body of that Sage
Is said to have the eighty excellent minor marks,
The eighty excellent minor marks of the Sugata,
I wish to explain; please listen, O King.

His nails are raised, his nails are like copper in color,
His nails are glossy, and the fingers of his hands are even;
His fingers are rounded, his fingers are full,
And his fingers taper gradually.
His veins are not visible, his lips are like the bimba fruit;
His two feet are even, and his ankles are not visible.
The lines of his hands are gradually fine,
And those lines are deep and very clear.
His tongue is copper-colored, very supple and soft;
His joints are not visible, and his arms are very long.
He has a voice like the trumpeting of an elephant,
A gentle voice, pleasing like thunder.
His body is well proportioned, clear, and very firm;
A most excellent body, the lines of his hands glossy;
The substance of his body is utterly pure;
The Moon of Victors is most dignified in body.
His body is perfectly poised,
His limbs well spread, a body without blemish;
The upper part of his body is full, broad, and very firm.
The excellent minor marks are perfectly complete.
His body is gradually rounded and very beautiful;
His conduct is pure, and his body very soft.
The hollow of his navel is without blemish,
Perfectly formed and very deep.
His radiance is without blemish and wholly pure;
His body is excellent in every way and very firm.
It is fully endowed with all-round excellence;
One never tires of beholding the Protector's body.
He walks with a majestic gait like an elephant,
With the gait of a bull, the gait of a lion and of a goose.
His speech is not too loud;

He has an excellent body, a body soft and glossy.
His arms are very rounded, soft, and beautiful;
He moves turning to the right, his manner of walking beautiful and fine.
He has a belly that rests well and evenly;
His body is free of desire and fear, and without blemish.
His eyebrows are black, very long, and beautiful;
His belly is not sunken, and the line of his eyes is long.
His face is most excellent, and he has pure eyes;
He has stainless eyes, and his eyes are very wide.
His canine teeth rise gradually upward;
His brows curve like a rainbow, and his nose is high in shape.
He has eyes like the petals of the blue utpala lotus.
His eyebrows are thick, and his canine teeth are rounded;
His eyebrows are even and finely joined;
His two ears are even, and his canine teeth are sharp.
The cheeks of his face are free of any defect;
The Victor's conduct has not the least trace of fault.
The breadth of his forehead has no wrinkles;
His neck is like a conch, and he has a firm body;
His joints have the strength of Nārāyaṇa.
His supreme limb, the head, is shaped like a parasol.
The crown of his head has coiled locks;
His hair is black and thick, with a sweet and fragrant scent;
The Victor's hair is not disheveled;
His hair is not tangled; his is a most beautiful body.
His hair is thick and well arranged in order;
His head hair and body hair are soft, fine, and black;
His hair is black like the belly of a bee;
Even and smooth, his supreme head of hair is like waves.
A lion throne, a fish, a victory banner,
A vajra, a hook, a vase, a coiled swastika,
The śrīvatsa, a conch, and a lotus:
These auspicious signs he has on his palms and soles.
Great King, these fine and beautiful things
Are the supreme excellent minor marks of the Sugata.
All these fine features I have described
Are found in no other person, in no non-Buddhist (tīrthika).

Great King, this, for a start, is the greatness of the form of the ascetic Gautama. Since it is found in no other sentient being, for that reason there is no fault in him.

Great King, the ascetic Gautama has the power of great loving-kindness; he has a mind free of anger toward all sentient beings. That loving-kindness of his is, moreover, without attachment and without obscuration, and it arises constantly. Spontaneously present, it fills everything vastly, pervades all world systems, and accords with the intentions of all sentient beings. Great King, to give an example: the precious water-clearing jewel is pure by its intrinsic nature and makes all the turbidity of water clear. Great King, in the same way the ascetic Gautama too is completely pure within and clears away the turbidity of the afflictions of all sentient beings; for that reason there is no fault in him.

On this it is said:

In all times and in all fields,
He pervades the world with loving-kindness.
The intentions of all beings, too,
He pervades, the All-Knowing One, endowed with love.
There is not a single direction
Unpervaded by the loving-kindness of the peerless Sage;
It pervades the elements and the intentions of beings as well.
Therefore the All-Knowing One has no fault.
Just as the water-clearing jewel,
Utterly pure, makes the water clear,
So the Sage, whose mind is pure,
Clears away the turbidity of beings.

Great King, the ascetic Gautama is endowed with great compassion of thirty-two aspects. If one asks what those thirty-two aspects are, they are these.

When he sees the world dwelling sunk in the darkness of delusion, the great compassion of the ascetic Gautama goes out to sentient beings. When he sees the world dwelling enclosed in the eggshell of great ignorance, the great compassion of the ascetic Gautama goes out to sentient beings. When he sees sentient beings fallen into the great round of saṃsāra, the great compassion of the ascetic Gautama goes out to sentient beings. When he sees sentient beings who are ever restless and never at peace, the great compassion of the

ascetic Gautama goes out to sentient beings. When he sees sentient beings swept away by the great river of the afflictions, following along with its current, the great compassion of the ascetic Gautama goes out to sentient beings. When he sees sentient beings who have fallen from a great precipice and are undergoing great suffering, the great compassion of the ascetic Gautama goes out to sentient beings. When he sees sentient beings who have entered a bad path and are separated from the noble path, the great compassion of the ascetic Gautama goes out to sentient beings. When he sees sentient beings bound by the great bonds of the afflictions and ever entangled in their coils, the great compassion of the ascetic Gautama goes out to sentient beings. When he sees sentient beings who for a long time have been hard to satisfy with sense objects and know no contentment, the great compassion of the ascetic Gautama goes out to sentient beings. When he sees sentient beings enslaved by craving and always under the control of others, the great compassion of the ascetic Gautama goes out to sentient beings. When he sees sentient beings tormented by old age and death and deeply afflicted, the great compassion of the ascetic Gautama goes out to sentient beings. When he sees sentient beings tormented by many and various diseases and always sick, the great compassion of the ascetic Gautama goes out to sentient beings. When he sees sentient beings ablaze with the three fires and always burning, the great compassion of the ascetic Gautama goes out to sentient beings. When he sees sentient beings who are lowly and impure and whose saṃsāra keeps increasing, the great compassion of the ascetic Gautama goes out to sentient beings. When he sees sentient beings who are always afraid and always fearful at heart, the great compassion of the ascetic Gautama goes out to sentient beings. When he sees sentient beings attached to slight pleasures of taste and not seeing their danger, the great compassion of the ascetic Gautama goes out to sentient beings. When he sees sentient beings intoxicated by many kinds of pride and long sunk in sleep, the great compassion of the ascetic Gautama goes out to sentient beings. When he sees sentient beings who have set out on the road through a great wilderness with killers always following close behind them, the great compassion of the ascetic Gautama goes out to sentient beings. When he sees sentient beings who are always being harmed, and at all times, the great compassion of the ascetic Gautama goes out to sentient beings. When he sees sentient beings blinded by ignorance and always veiled by cataracts, the great compassion of the ascetic Gautama goes out to sentient beings. When he sees sentient beings who have become like a tangled weave, like a knotted ball of

thread, like muñja grass and balbaja grass, the great compassion of the ascetic Gautama goes out to sentient beings. When he sees sentient beings who are beset with harm and deprived of freedom from harm, the great compassion of the ascetic Gautama goes out to sentient beings. When he sees sentient beings caught in unfavorable states and deprived of leisure, the great compassion of the ascetic Gautama goes out to sentient beings. When he sees sentient beings full of doubt who have entered into wrong views, the great compassion of the ascetic Gautama goes out to sentient beings. When he sees sentient beings who are like tufts of cotton and lean on a variety of views, the great compassion of the ascetic Gautama goes out to sentient beings. When he sees sentient beings whose perceptions and minds are inverted, who perceive the impermanent as permanent, suffering as pleasure, the unattractive as attractive, and what has no real existence as really existent, the great compassion of the ascetic Gautama goes out to sentient beings. When he sees sentient beings oppressed by their burden, long exhausted and suffering, the great compassion of the ascetic Gautama goes out to sentient beings. When he sees sentient beings who rely on what has little power and perceive what has no essence as essential, the great compassion of the ascetic Gautama goes out to sentient beings. When he sees sentient beings ever beset by secondary afflictions and stained by defilement, the great compassion of the ascetic Gautama goes out to sentient beings. When he sees sentient beings ruined by desire for existence and dejected in mind, the great compassion of the ascetic Gautama goes out to sentient beings. When he sees sentient beings overwhelmed by gain and honor and always seeking gain, the great compassion of the ascetic Gautama goes out to sentient beings. When he sees sentient beings tormented by sorrow, by lamentation, by suffering, by unhappiness, and by many kinds of turmoil, the great compassion of the ascetic Gautama arises for sentient beings.

The ascetic Gautama is endowed with great compassion having these thirty-two aspects, and for that reason there is no fault in him.

On this it is said:

When he sees the people whose minds are ever obscured
By the darkness, the black darkness, of delusion,
And those confined in the prison of saṃsāra,
That holy sage gives rise to compassion.
When he sees sentient beings ever restless,
Ever carried away by the four rivers,

And dwelling in the current of saṃsāra,
Compassion arises in the One with the Ten Powers.
When he sees sentient beings fallen into a great abyss,
Or who have set out on a bad path,
The Sage in his compassion sets them in the place of peace
And on the royal road of the noble ones.
When he sees sentient beings in bondage, enslaved by craving,
Ever attached to sense objects, and fallen into the depths
Of old age and of death,
The compassion of the One with the Ten Powers arises in full.
When he sees these people tormented by many kinds of suffering,
Ablaze with the three fires,
And those in terror of the lower realms,
The compassion of the One with the Ten Powers arises in full.
When he sees sentient beings with minds greedy for taste,
Ever heedless and attached to sense objects,
Afflicted in the wilderness of existence,
He brings them to liberation.
When he sees sentient beings blind with ignorance and veiled by cataracts,
Become like balbaja and muñja grass,
And full of hatred,
The compassion of the One with the Ten Powers arises in full.
When he sees those whose minds are bound to saṃsāra,
These people born into unfavorable states,
And those fallen into wrong views,
The compassion of the One with the Ten Powers arises in full.
When he sees the deluded, who take suffering as pleasure, the unattractive as attractive,
The impermanent as permanent, and perceive as a self
What has no self,
The compassion of the One with the Ten Powers arises in full.
When he sees those crushed and oppressed by their burden,
Likewise the childish who rely on what has little power,
And the afflicted, ever afflicted,
The compassion of the One with the Ten Powers arises in full.
Seeing those whose minds are overwhelmed by desire,
Whose craving is great and who are ever greedy for sense objects,

Fallen into the ocean of desire for existence,
The great compassion of the Victor arises.
Seeing the afflicted people sorely oppressed
By disease and by many kinds of sorrow,
In order to dispel their suffering without remainder,
The compassion of the One with the Ten Powers arises in full.
The great compassion of the Sage arises always;
That it should not arise is never possible.
It abides in the intentions of all beings;
Therefore that Buddha has no fault.

Great King, in brief, the ascetic Gautama possesses the four applications of mindfulness. Great King, the ascetic Gautama possesses the four correct exertions, the four bases of miraculous power, the five faculties, the five powers, the seven branches of awakening, and the noble eightfold path; for that reason there is no fault in him.

On this it is said:

He knows the four applications of mindfulness;
He knows the four correct exertions, and he is without equal;
In the practice of samādhi and dhyāna his mastery is great;
Thus that great being has no fault.
The sole Protector of the world, through the bases of miraculous power,
Has gone to the far shore of the discriminating knowledges.
The great sage is skilled in knowledge and liberation;
The Sage is pure and knows the means for sentient beings.
Over loving-kindness, compassion, joy, and equanimity,
The four abodes of Brahmā, he has mastery.
He is a yogin in both insight and calm abiding;
Therefore there is never any fault in him.
He wears the supreme jewel ornament of the branches of awakening;
Washed in the stainless water of the eightfold path,
He sets beings upon that very path,
Blissful, unshakable, and free of all fear.
There is no sentient being at all in this world
Who is the equal of that bull among sages.
He outshines all and possesses every good quality;
In that lord of good qualities there is nothing to blame.

Great King, the ascetic Gautama possesses the ten powers.

The king said, "Great brahmin, what are those ten powers of the Tathāgata?"

He replied, "Great King, they are these. Here the Tathāgata knows fully, just as it is, what is possible as possible, and he knows fully, just as it is, what is impossible as impossible. Great King, this is the first tathāgata power of the ascetic Gautama.

"The Tathāgata knows fully, just as it is, the undertaking of actions, past, future, and present, in terms of their basis, their kind, and their maturation.

"He knows fully, just as they are, the world's many elements and its various elements.

"He knows fully, just as they are, the many inclinations and the various inclinations of other sentient beings and other persons.

"He knows fully, just as it is, the knowledge of the higher and lower faculties of other sentient beings and other persons.

"He knows fully, just as it is, the path that leads everywhere.

"He knows fully, just as they are, the defilement, the purification, and the cleansing of the faculties, the powers, the branches of awakening, the dhyānas, the liberations, the samādhis, and the meditative attainments of other sentient beings and other persons.

"He recollects his many former lives: he recollects a single life, and as many as many hundreds of thousands of koṭis of niyutas of lives; he recollects his many former lives with their details, with their places, and with their circumstances.

"With the divine eye, purified and surpassing the human, he sees sentient beings dying and being born, and taking birth in happy destinies and in unhappy destinies.

"Through the exhaustion of the defilements he knows fully, just as it is, the undefiled liberation of mind and liberation through wisdom. This is the tenth tathāgata power of the ascetic Gautama.

"Great King, these are the ten powers of the Tathāgata. Because he possesses these powers, the Tathāgata is called one who has the ten powers, and for that reason there is no fault in him."

On this it is said:

What is possible, and likewise what is impossible,
He knows just as it truly is;
The great hero speaks the truth;
There is no fault in him.
Toward the time that is past
His unattached wisdom engages;
Toward the present and the future
His wisdom has no confusion.
Actions and the maturation of actions,
And whatever knowledge there is of causes,
All of these without exception
The Guide of the world knows.
The world with its many elements
And with its various elements he knows;
Skilled in the ways of knowing the elements,
Among the persons of the world he has no equal.
Those with various inclinations
And likewise those with many inclinations,
That Lamp of the World knows
Just as they truly are, and not otherwise.
He knows fully the dull faculties,
And likewise knows the middling faculties;
He knows the fully ripened faculties;
He is lord over the whole range of faculties.
The path that leads everywhere
He knows just as it truly is.
The superknowledges, faculties, dhyānas, and powers,
The branches of awakening and the liberations he knows;
Defilement and purification,
And how they are set forth, he knows as well.
Since he has the vision of unobstructed wisdom,
There is no obstruction for him at all.
Former lives beyond measure
He sees in their many aspects,
His own and those of others without exception,
Just as they truly are, and not otherwise.
His eye is without stain
And far surpasses the human;

The death, passing on, and birth of beings
That Guide sees fully.
He knows the exhaustion of the defilements,
And he knows liberation fully;
Whatever the undefiled element may be,
That the Guide knows fully.
These ten powers of the Buddha, the great sovereign,
Have no equal.
Though they all abide in a single mind,
He has no conceptual thought in his mind;
In a way that has nothing to take up and nothing to cast aside,
They arise spontaneously.
Like the momentum of a wheel that was spun before,
They arise without conceptual thought.
Whatever all sentient beings think
He knows fully with a single mind;
Yet toward minds and sentient beings
No dualistic notion arises.
Therefore in the Buddha, the sovereign,
There is no fault whatsoever;
Skilled in all phenomena,
His glory of good qualities surpasses all.

Great King, the ascetic Gautama possesses the four fearlessnesses.

The king said, "Great brahmin, what are the four fearlessnesses of the Tathāgata, by possessing which the ascetic Gautama is said to possess the four fearlessnesses?"

He replied, "Great King, here, when the ascetic Gautama declares of himself, 'I am a perfectly and completely awakened buddha,' he does not see any ground on which anyone in the world, with its gods, its māras and its Brahmās, among its people with their ascetics and brahmins, could rightly challenge him, saying, 'You have not fully and completely awakened to these phenomena.' Because he does not see any such ground, he dwells having found ease and having found fearlessness. He lays claim to the place of the bull, he rightly roars the lion's roar in the assembly, and he turns the wheel of Brahmā, which no ascetic, brahmin, or anyone else whatever has turned in the world in accordance with the Dharma.

"When his defilements are exhausted and he declares of himself, 'My defilements are exhausted,' he does not see any ground on which anyone in the world, with its gods, its māras and its Brahmās, among its people with their ascetics and brahmins, could rightly challenge him, saying, 'Those defilements of yours are not exhausted.' Because he does not see any such ground, he dwells having found ease and having found fearlessness. He lays claim to the place of the bull, he rightly roars the lion's roar in the assembly, and he turns the wheel of Brahmā, which no ascetic, brahmin, or anyone else whatever has turned in the world in accordance with the Dharma.

"He does not see any ground on which anyone in the world, with its gods, its māras and its Brahmās, among its people with their ascetics and brahmins, could rightly challenge him, saying, 'Those things that the Tathāgata has declared to be obstacles do not become obstacles even when one indulges in them.' Because he does not see any such ground, he dwells having found ease and having found fearlessness. He lays claim to the place of the bull, he rightly roars the lion's roar in the assembly, and he turns the wheel of Brahmā, which no ascetic, brahmin, or anyone else whatever has turned in the world in accordance with the Dharma.

"He does not see any ground on which anyone in the world, with its gods, its māras and its Brahmās, among its people with their ascetics and brahmins, could rightly challenge him, saying, 'The noble path of deliverance that the Tathāgata has taught does not truly become the cause of the exhaustion of suffering, even when one follows it.' Because he does not see any such ground, he dwells having found ease and having found fearlessness. He lays claim to the place of the bull, he rightly roars the lion's roar in the assembly, and he turns the wheel of Brahmā, which no ascetic, brahmin, or anyone else whatever has turned in the world in accordance with the Dharma.

"Great King, these are the four fearlessnesses of the Tathāgata. The Tathāgata who possesses them rightly roars the lion's roar in the assembly, and for that reason there is no fault in him."

On this it is said:

"There is no sentient being equal to me,
So how could there be one greater?"
So saying, the Guide of humankind
Roars the lion's roar in the assembly.
"The phenomena to which I have awakened

Are true, and they are not otherwise."
Seeing this, that perfect Buddha
Is free of fear, like a lion.
He sees no true ground at all
On which some might challenge him;
Since he sees no such ground,
The Guide proclaims without fear:
"All defilements have been exhausted;
In my body there is no defilement.
Therefore in the world with its gods
There is no one at all equal to me.
Whatever things are obstacles,
Those I have taught to people,
All of them I have declared truly;
It is not otherwise.
Whatever things lead to deliverance,
Those I taught in full after my awakening;
When one relies upon those things,
No obstacle will arise."
Such things the great hero knows.
Because the Tathāgata has found ease,
He has found the ease of fearlessness,
And the Sage abides free of fear.
The wheel of Brahmā, which no one had turned,
He turns in full;
Apart from the most excellent of two-footed beings,
No one in the worlds is able to turn it.

Great King, the ascetic Gautama also possesses these eighteen unshared qualities of a buddha.

The king said, "Great brahmin, what are those eighteen unshared qualities of a buddha that the ascetic Gautama has?"

He replied, "Great King, the eighteen unshared qualities of a buddha are these. The Tathāgata has no error; he has no noisiness; he has no forgetfulness; he has no mind that is not in equipoise; he has no perception of diversity; he has no equanimity that lacks discernment; he has no decline in aspiration; he has no decline in diligence; he has no decline in mindfulness; he

has no decline in samādhi; he has no decline in wisdom; he has no decline in liberation. All his bodily actions are preceded by wisdom and follow after wisdom; all his verbal actions are preceded by wisdom and follow after wisdom; all his mental actions are preceded by wisdom and follow after wisdom. His seeing of wisdom, unattached and unobstructed, engages the past; his seeing of wisdom, unattached and unobstructed, engages the future; his seeing of wisdom, unattached and unobstructed, engages the present. These eighteen are the unshared qualities of a buddha that belong to the ascetic Gautama. Great King, since the Tathāgata possesses these eighteen unshared qualities of a buddha, for that reason there is no fault in him."

On this it is said:

The Buddha has no error,
Nor likewise any noisiness;
His intention has no lapse;
Therefore the All-Knowing One has no fault.
He has no perception of diversity,
He has no distracted mind;
His equanimity is discerning,
And he has no decline in aspiration.
His diligence ever blazes,
And he has no forgetfulness;
In wisdom and in liberation,
And in seeing the faculties, he has no decline.
Through his wisdom he is never perturbed.
In his body, speech, and mind
Wisdom goes before,
And they follow after wisdom.
He is never parted from wisdom;
Toward the past it meets no obstruction;
Toward the future and the present too
His wisdom meets no obstruction.
Since such are the qualities
Of that great-souled ascetic,
The others besides these, beyond measure,
I am not able to count.

Then King Caṇḍa Pradyota, having heard of such inconceivable qualities and greatness of the Tathāgata, was satisfied, pleased, and delighted; he rejoiced

greatly, and joy and happiness arose in him. Boundless and inconceivable faith arose in him toward Satyavādin, son of the Nirgranthas. He came to regard him as a teacher, and he also gained the perception of him as a spiritual friend, as one who teaches awakening, as one who carries others across to omniscience, as one who rightly urges others on, as one who brings about recollection, and as one who abides in the inconceivable liberation of the bodhisattvas. With a mind endowed with such perception and attention, he draped over Satyavādin, son of the Nirgranthas, a pearl necklace worth a hundred thousand, and a pair of priceless fine cotton cloths, in honor of the Dharma. And he also spoke these words as an inspired utterance:

"Satyavādin, excellent, excellent, that you have so well spoken this kind of skill in the ways of the Dharma! Satyavādin, this teaching of the Dharma that you have given is in accord, for it accords with the wisdom of omniscience. This teaching of the Dharma that you have given brings about the attainment of omniscience. This teaching of the Dharma that you have given leads out of saṃsāra. This teaching of the Dharma that you have given purifies the stains of the afflictions. This teaching of the Dharma that you have given breaks down the doors of avarice. This teaching of the Dharma that you have given beats the drums of generosity. This teaching of the Dharma that you have given topples the mountains of pride. This teaching of the Dharma that you have given dries up the ocean of craving. This teaching of the Dharma that you have given lights up the thick darkness of unknowing. This teaching of the Dharma that you have given does not let pass the right time and measure for bringing sentient beings to maturity."

When he had said this, Satyavādin, son of the Nirgranthas, said to King Caṇḍa Pradyota, "Great King, it is just so. There is no conduct of the bodhisattvas whatsoever that does not serve to tame sentient beings. There is no teaching of the Dharma whatsoever that is not in accord with the Great Vehicle. There is none that does not truly accomplish the wisdom of omniscience. There is none that does not bring all the afflictions to exhaustion. There is none that does not show the faults of saṃsāra. There is none that does not accomplish nirvāṇa. There is none that is not in accord with the conduct of a bodhisattva.

"Great King, every undertaking of the bodhisattvas brings to complete fulfillment their own benefit, the benefit of others, and the benefit of both."

When Satyavādin, son of the Nirgranthas, had given this teaching, King Caṇḍa Pradyota attained irreversible faith. Sixteen young princes attained the faith

called Domain of the Force of Joy. Eighteen thousand sons of the gods attained the meditative absorption called Array of the Buddha's Ornaments. From among the people of the royal palace and the retinue of the son of the Nirgranthas, thirteen thousand people gave rise to the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening. All of them put their own garments on Satyavādin, son of the Nirgranthas, so as to clothe him with the Dharma, and they spoke these words: "It is our good fortune, well gained, that we have thus seen the noble son Satyavādin and heard this harmonious teaching of the Dharma." Having said this, they also said, "Satyavādin, come! Let us go now to see the Blessed One, to bow to him, and to attend upon him. That Tathāgata is staying in our own pleasure garden."

Satyavādin said, "Let everyone come! Together with the king, together with the army, together with the townspeople, together with the people of the country, and together with the people of the retinue, let us all join in concord and go in great array."

Then King Caṇḍa Pradyota had a bell sounded throughout the whole city and proclaimed, "Whoever does not go before the Tathāgata, the punishment for him is death." Then all the men, women, boys and girls of the city, having heard that command of King Caṇḍa Pradyota, took up flowers, incense, garlands, ointments, cymbals and drums, went out from the great city of Ujjayinī, and, ready to go to the pleasure garden, stood waiting for King Caṇḍa Pradyota.

Then King Caṇḍa Pradyota, together with Satyavādin, son of the Nirgranthas, together with the host of ministers, with the young princes, together with the troops of the army, together with the retinue of queens, together with the townspeople and the people of the country, and together with the people of the retinue and the doorkeepers, was surrounded on all sides by them all. With a great array of troops sent ahead of him, parasols, victory banners and pennants were raised aloft; hundreds of thousands of koṭis of cymbals were made to clamor; the sounds and melodies of dance, song and music rang out; the sounds of the instruments called kimapala and nakula, of gongs and of drums rang out; horses and elephants gave voice; and those bearing hundreds of thousands of auspicious vases tied with golden cords were sent on ahead. Together with the elephant charioteers and the horse charioteers, and together with nine million eight hundred thousand living beings, with great royal might, great royal wealth, great royal display and great royal pageantry, he went to his own pleasure garden, to where the Blessed One was. Having

arrived, he bowed his head at the feet of the Blessed One, circumambulated him three times, and sat down to one side. Satyavādin, son of the Nirgranthas, together with his retinue, also bowed his head at the feet of the Blessed One, circumambulated him many hundreds of thousands of times, and, with his palms joined, remained gazing at the Blessed One without blinking.

Then the venerable Śāriputra saw Satyavādin, son of the Nirgranthas, sitting in the presence of the Blessed One, gazing at the Blessed One without blinking. Seeing him, he thought, "Oh! What can this Satyavādin, son of the Nirgranthas, want, that he has come here?" Having reflected thus, he said to Satyavādin, son of the Nirgranthas, "Satyavādin, what do you want, that you have come before the Tathāgata? Do you wish to see the Blessed One, or do you wish to hear the Dharma?"

When he had said this, Satyavādin, son of the Nirgranthas, said to the venerable Śāradvatīputra, "Venerable Śāradvatīputra, I do not wish to see the Blessed One, nor do I wish to hear the Dharma. Venerable Śāradvatīputra, I have come before the Blessed One because I do not wish for any phenomena at all. Why is that? Venerable Śāradvatīputra, because seeing form is not seeing the Tathāgata. Seeing feeling, perception, formations and consciousness is not seeing the Tathāgata. Seeing the earth element is not seeing the Tathāgata. Seeing the water element, the fire element and the wind element is not seeing the Tathāgata. Seeing a self is not seeing the Tathāgata. Seeing a sentient being or a life is not seeing the Tathāgata. Seeing a person is not seeing the Tathāgata. Seeing the grasping at 'I' is not seeing the Tathāgata. Seeing the grasping at 'mine' is not seeing the Tathāgata. Seeing signs is not seeing the Tathāgata. Venerable Śāradvatīputra, not seeing any signs at all is seeing the Tathāgata. Seeing the absence of clinging is seeing the Tathāgata. Seeing the absence of entities is seeing the Tathāgata. Seeing the absence of essential nature is seeing the Tathāgata. Seeing that there is no limit of reality is seeing the Tathāgata. Seeing the eye as free of attachment to forms is seeing the Tathāgata. Seeing the ear as without cognizance of sounds is seeing the Tathāgata. Seeing the nose as not moving toward odors is seeing the Tathāgata. Not seeing the tongue as cognizing tastes is seeing the Tathāgata. Not seeing the body as touching tangibles is seeing the Tathāgata. Seeing the mind as apprehending mental objects without conceptualizing them is seeing the Tathāgata.

Śāradvatīputra said, "Satyavādin, if seeing in that way is seeing the Tathāgata, then how should the Tathāgata be looked upon?"

Satyavādin said, "Venerable Śāradvatīputra, the Tathāgata is not looked upon as a family. He is not looked upon as a lineage. He is not looked upon as a characteristic. He is not looked upon as without characteristics. He is not looked upon as a phenomenon. He is not looked upon as a non-phenomenon. He is not looked upon as real. He is not looked upon as unreal. He is not looked upon as an object of focus. He is not looked upon as without an object of focus. He is not looked upon as something to be attended to. He is not looked upon as without attention. He is not looked upon as conception. He is not looked upon as non-conception. He is not looked upon as conditioned. He is not looked upon as unconditioned. He is not looked upon as an existing entity. He is not looked upon as a nonexistent entity. He is not looked upon as a lump. He is not looked upon as a substance. He is not looked upon as form. He is not looked upon as feeling. He is not looked upon as perception. He is not looked upon as formations. He is not looked upon as consciousness. He is not looked upon as appropriation. He is not looked upon as without appropriation. The Tathāgata is not looked upon as arising. He is not looked upon as non-arising."

When he had said this, the venerable Śāradvatīputra said to Satyavādin, son of the Nirgranthas, "Satyavādin, if the Tathāgata is not looked upon in that way, then how do you, holy being, look upon the Tathāgata?"

He said, "Venerable Śāradvatīputra, I do not look upon the Tathāgata as form. Nor do I look upon the Tathāgata as other than form. Nor do I look upon the Tathāgata for the sake of destroying form. Venerable Śāradvatīputra, I do not look upon the Tathāgata as feeling, perception, formations or consciousness. Nor do I look upon the Tathāgata as other than consciousness. Nor do I look upon the Tathāgata for the sake of destroying consciousness. I do not look upon the Tathāgata as belonging to the world. I do not look upon the Tathāgata as having crossed beyond the world. I do not look upon the Tathāgata as divided up into aggregates. I do not look upon the Tathāgata as divided up into elements. I do not look upon the Tathāgata as divided up into sense sources. Rather, I look upon the Tathāgata as inexpressible by any path of words; and in no way seeing him, not discerning him, not apprehending him, not conceiving him, not conceptualizing him, not imagining him at all, without pretension, without instigation, without taking up, without casting away, without conceptual elaboration, without making him a sign, and yet not without making him a sign, without activity, without fabrication, without making him exist, without making him not exist, without accepting, without rejecting, without intention, without spontaneous accomplishment, and yet not

unapprehendable either: thus do I look upon the Tathāgata. Inexpressible, and yet not inexpressible either: thus do I look upon the Tathāgata. Because he has wholly passed beyond every path of words and every vocal utterance, I look upon the Tathāgata without seeing. Venerable Śāradvatīputra, the bodhisattvas too look upon the Tathāgata in this way, and I too look upon him in the same way."

Śāradvatīputra said, "If the Tathāgata is looked upon in this way, then how does one listen to his teaching of the Dharma?"

He said, "Venerable Śāradvatīputra, if any perception of the Dharma arose in me, or any perception of what is not the Dharma arose, then I too would listen to the Blessed One's teaching of the Dharma. Why is that? Venerable Śāradvatīputra, no word of the bodhisattva's Dharma emerges from any expression at all, because there is no clinging to it and no perception of the Dharma is produced. Why is that? Because it is free of all perceptions."

Śāradvatīputra said, "Satyavādin, have you not come before the Tathāgata in order to seek the Dharma?"

He said, "Venerable Śāradvatīputra, I have come before the Tathāgata neither seeking the Dharma nor seeking what is not the Dharma. Why is that? Venerable Śāradvatīputra, what is called 'seeking the Dharma' is a designation for not seeking any phenomenon at all. Venerable Śāradvatīputra, whoever seeks the Dharma does not wish to cling to the Buddha, does not wish to superimpose anything upon the Dharma, and does not wish to generate the Saṅgha. He does not wish to fully understand suffering, does not wish to abandon its origin, does not wish to cultivate the path, and does not wish to realize cessation. He does not wish to pass beyond the desire realm, does not wish to pass beyond the form realm and the formless realm, and does not wish to pass into nirvāṇa. Venerable Śāradvatīputra, for this reason it should be understood that I have come into the presence of the Tathāgata without seeking any phenomenon at all."

When he had said this, the venerable Śāradvatīputra said to Satyavādin, son of the Nirgranthas, "Satyavādin, with what in mind do you say this?"

He said, "Venerable Śāradvatīputra, I teach all phenomena in this way without having anything in mind. Venerable Śāradvatīputra, since in the realm of phenomena no duality is apprehended, neither having something in mind nor not having something in mind is apprehended."

He said, "Satyavādin, are you not bound to the destinies of rebirth?"

He said, "Venerable Śāradvatīputra, if I apprehended any destiny, there would also be a binding. If there were any birth for me, I would also be born. If there were any transmigration for me, I would also transmigrate. But, Venerable Śāradvatīputra, all phenomena are without transmigration: they have no going, no death and transmigration, and no birth."

He said, "Satyavādin, did the Tathāgata not say this: 'Monk, you are born, you age, you die, you transmigrate, you come into being'?"

He said, "Venerable Śāradvatīputra, the Tathāgata teaches in that way in order to remove the reliance of those beings who rely on the destinies and are possessed of excessive pride. If one takes the teaching in accordance with its true nature, there is here no going, no death and transmigration, and no birth."

Śāradvatīputra said, "Satyavādin, excellent, excellent! Excellent, excellent, that you are thus skilled in the meaning and the ascertainment of what this Great Vehicle teaches!"

Satyavādin said, "Venerable Śāradvatīputra, do you know what the meaning is, and what the ascertainment is?"

Śāradvatīputra said, "Noble son, I do not wish to teach; I wish to listen. Noble son, you explain what the meaning is and what the ascertainment is."

When he had said this, Satyavādin, son of the Nirgranthas, said to the venerable Śāradvatīputra, "Venerable Śāradvatīputra, what is called the meaning is inexpressible; whatever expresses it is called the ascertainment. What is called the meaning is unspeakable; whatever speaks it is called the ascertainment. What is called the meaning cannot be stated; whatever states it is called the ascertainment. What is called the meaning is without movement, without thought, without conceptual elaboration, without examination, without fabrication, without entity, without substance, without grasping at 'I', without waves, without anything grasped, without basis, and has wholly passed beyond every path of words concerning a basis. What is called the ascertainment is what makes it understood in the mental continuum of others through reflecting, measuring, counting and examining. What is called the meaning is the analytical knowledge of meaning. What is called the ascertainment is the analytical knowledge of phenomena, of language and of eloquence. Venerable Śāradvatīputra, this, in brief, is the meaning, and this is

the ascertainment."

Then the Blessed One gave his approval to the noble son Satyavādin, saying, "Excellent!" "Noble son, excellent, excellent! As you teach, so should others teach as well. Through your explaining this teaching, three thousand sons of the gods have attained acceptance of the nonarising of phenomena. Twenty thousand living beings, having heard this perfect greatness of your eloquence, have given rise to the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening."

Then the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, how many sentient beings has the noble son Satyavādin brought to maturity in this guise of a non-Buddhist (tīrthika)?"

When he had asked this, the Blessed One said to the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana, "Mahāmaudgalyāyana, if they heard about this matter, the world with its gods would be bewildered, except for the bodhisattva great beings. Nevertheless, Mahāmaudgalyāyana, I will give just a brief indication. Listen to how many sentient beings this noble son Satyavādin has brought to maturity through various colors, forms and modes of conduct. Mahāmaudgalyāyana, abiding in the form of a non-Buddhist, this noble son Satyavādin has brought to maturity for unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening as many sentient beings as there are atoms in Mount Sumeru. In the form of a wandering ascetic he has brought to maturity for unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening as many sentient beings as there are atoms in the four continents. In the form of a mendicant he has brought to maturity for unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening as many sentient beings as there are grains of sand in eighty-four Ganges rivers. In the form of a śrāvaka he showed as many sentient beings as there are grains of sand in ten Ganges rivers how to go forth toward the awakening of a śrāvaka, and afterward brought them to maturity for unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening. Even more sentient beings than that he has brought to maturity in the form of a pratyekabuddha. In the form of a bodhisattva he has brought to maturity sentient beings beyond counting. Others in the form of Śakra, others in the form of Brahmā, others in the form of a universal monarch, others in the form of a world guardian, others in the form of a kinnara, others in the form of an asura, others in the form of a garuḍa, others in the form of a mahoraga, others in the form of a man, others in the form of a woman, others in the form of a boy, others in the form of a girl, others in the form of an earth deity, others in the form of a coemergent deity, others in the form of a sage, others in the

form of a brahmin, others in the form of a monk, others in the form of a nun, others in the form of a layman, and others in the form of a laywoman he has brought to maturity for unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening. Maudgalyāyana, in this way this noble son Satyavādin has brought many sentient beings to maturity for unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening."

He asked, "How many tathāgatas has he pleased?"

The Blessed One said, "Maudgalyāyana, it might be possible to reach the limit of the earth element, the water element, the fire element, the wind element, the space element and the realm of sentient beings, but it is not possible to reach the limit of those buddhas who have appeared, the tathāgatas whom this noble son Satyavādin has pleased through various forms."

Then the elder Mahākāśyapa said to the noble son Satyavādin, "Noble son, if you have pleased many tathāgatas, why, with your intention thus fulfilled, do you not fully awaken to unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening?"

Satyavādin said, "Venerable Kāśyapa, if I apprehended any awakening of mine, or anyone who fully awakens, then I too would fully awaken to unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening."

He said, "Satyavādin, have not bodhisattvas as numerous as the grains of sand of the Ganges river made aspirations for unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening, and fully awakened to unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening? Do they not fully awaken? Will they not come to fully awaken?"

He said, "Venerable Kāśyapa, that is reckoned in terms of beings who have overweening pride. Here, ultimately, awakening is not apprehended, and a bodhisattva is not apprehended either."

"Why is that? Venerable Kāśyapa, awakening is unconditioned in this way. It is free of all enumeration, formless and indemonstrable. It is not blue, not yellow, not white, not crimson, and not the color of crystal. It is without color, without shape, without characteristic marks; signless, it has wholly passed beyond all signs. It is without basis, having wholly destroyed every basis. It is without entity, free of all entities. It is without defining characteristics, free of all defining characteristics. It is inexpressible, and cannot be realized through any path of words. It cannot be looked upon. It is not a whole. It is without substance, without darkness, without light, without characteristic marks,

without shape. It is unspeakable and cannot be stated. It is not tangible, cannot be cognized, and cannot be heard. It is without sound, without a path of words, and without obstruction. It is neither bound nor freed. It is without attachment, without aversion, and without delusion. It cannot be designated by any causes, and is not something to be designated. Venerable Kāśyapa, since awakening has such a nature, one cannot fully awaken to it with the body, nor with the mind either. Why is that? Venerable Kāśyapa, the body is mindless and motionless, like grass, wood, a wall or a clod of earth seen before one; one cannot fully awaken to awakening with it. The mind too is of such a nature and cannot be looked upon; one cannot fully awaken to awakening with it either. And the sentient beings who would fully awaken are not apprehended either. Venerable Kāśyapa, since all phenomena have such a nature, why then should you come to think, 'Why do you not fully awaken to unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening?'"

Then those bodhisattvas; those monks, nuns, laymen and laywomen; and Śakra, Brahmā and those world guardians thought, "Would it not be good if the Blessed One, in order to dispel the doubt, hesitation and uncertainty of us sentient beings, in accordance with our intentions and inclinations, were to prophesy when this noble son Satyavādin will fully awaken to unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening, in what world system he will fully awaken, what his name will be once he has attained awakening, what the measure of his lifespan will be, and how great his gathered assembly will be once he has attained awakening?"

Then the Blessed One, knowing with his mind the thoughts in the minds of those bodhisattvas; those monks, nuns, laymen and laywomen; and Śakra, Brahmā and those world guardians, said to Mañjuśrī Kumārabhūta, "Mañjuśrī, after this Fortunate Eon has passed, and after as many further eons have passed as are beyond all counting, in the eon called Free of Foes Who Dare to Harm, in the world system called Renowned as Well Beheld, this noble son Satyavādin will become the tathāgata, arhat, perfectly and completely awakened buddha called King of the Crest of Truthful Intelligence.

"Mañjuśrī, that world system called Renowned as Well Beheld will be excellent, beautiful and lovely to behold. It will be fully adorned with the seven kinds of precious substances, surrounded by seven hundred thousand jeweled ramparts, and encircled in turn by seven hundred thousand moats of scented water. It will be planted with seven hundred thousand lattice rows of great precious beryl jewels and covered over from above by millions of nets of

Jambū river gold. It will have gateways adorned with millions of precious jewels. It will be made beautiful by parapets and windows decorated with millions of precious jewels called Lovely Lion. It will be made beautiful by turrets decorated with millions of precious jewels called Lion Banner. It will be made to blaze as one with light by millions of precious jewels called Banner of Light. It will be filled with the lovely sound rung out on every side by millions of nets of bells and tinkling chimes. It will have millions of golden tassels hung on every side. And it will have divine pennants of precious jewels called Banner of the Crest, and millions of victory banners raised aloft.

"Mañjuśrī, that world system Renowned as Well Beheld will be level like the palm of the hand and filled throughout with trees of precious substances. The grasses that grow there will be soft and curl to the right like a coiled svastika. Resembling the neck of a peacock, and soft as kācilindika cloth, they will cover that whole world system Renowned as Well Beheld. It will be adorned with millions of pleasure gardens. Each pleasure garden in turn will be well adorned and made beautiful throughout by millions of ponds. Each pond in turn will have eight stairways, decorated with precious jewels of eight qualities, strewn with sand of Jambū river gold, brimming with water of the eight qualities, covered throughout with lotuses of precious substances, and filled with geese, ruddy shelducks and cranes calling out their cries.

"Mañjuśrī, in this way that world system Renowned as Well Beheld will be adorned throughout with millions of villages, cities, towns, districts and royal capitals. Each great city in turn will be well adorned with millions upon millions of cities, and in the same way all the villages, cities, towns, districts and royal capitals will be just as many; and all those millions upon millions of villages, cities, towns and districts will be filled with many men, women, boys and girls."

"Mañjuśrī, in that world system Renowned as Well Beheld there will come to be a four-continent world system called Pleasing Even at a Glance: most lovely to behold, most beautiful, most prosperous, most flourishing, and filled with a great many men and women. It will be the city of birth of that Blessed One, the tathāgata, arhat, perfectly and completely awakened buddha King of the Crest of Truthful Intelligence.

"Mañjuśrī, that tathāgata King of the Crest of Truthful Intelligence will be born into a brahmin family. His mother will be called Endowed with Vigor; she will be like my own present mother, Queen Māyādevī. His father will be called Treasure of Brahmā; he will be like my own present father, King Śuddhodana.

His son will be called Renowned Voice; he will be like my own present youth Rāhula. His chief queen will be called Mahāmati; she will be like my own present Śākya maiden Gopā. His nurse will be called Great Renown; she will be like my own present Mahāprajāpatī Gautamī. That Blessed One's attendant will be called Ever Following; he will be like my own present attendant Chandaka. The king of horses on which that tathāgata King of the Crest of Truthful Intelligence will ride when he goes forth will be called Possessed of Strength; it will be like my own present king of horses, Kanthaka. That Blessed One's seat of awakening will be called Exalted by the Dharma, and there that tathāgata will fully awaken to unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening. That seat of awakening will be surrounded by eight million bodhi trees.

"Mañjuśrī, at that time, on that occasion, there will be no Māra and no gods of Māra's class. Mañjuśrī, when the tathāgata King of the Crest of Truthful Intelligence fully awakens to unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening, all the classes of sentient beings there are in that world system, however many, will take up flowers, garlands, incense, powders, ointments, cymbals and drums, go to the seat of awakening Exalted by the Dharma, and perform all kinds of songs and music. All the hosts of gods up to the very limit of the Akaniṣṭha heaven will gather there as well. Most of the hosts of yakṣas, gandharvas, asuras, kinnaras and mahoragas will also gather there. A great many hosts of bodhisattvas will gather from the east, the south, the west and the north as well.

"Mañjuśrī, when that tathāgata King of the Crest of Truthful Intelligence has first fully awakened, he will teach to the gathered assembly the great Dharma discourse Teaching the Miraculous Display in the Domain of Skillful Means in the Sphere of the Bodhisattvas, accompanied by many hundreds of thousands of koṭis of sūtras. Mañjuśrī, when that tathāgata King of the Crest of Truthful Intelligence teaches that Dharma discourse, as many sentient beings as there are grains of sand in the river Ganges will become irreversible from unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening. Mañjuśrī, that tathāgata King of the Crest of Truthful Intelligence will not teach the Dharma by setting out three vehicles; in that buddha field there will be no followers of the Śrāvaka Vehicle or of the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle. All the sentient beings born in that buddha field will be devoted to the One Vehicle, devoted solely to the vast.

"Mañjuśrī, in this way the first gathering of that tathāgata King of the Crest of Truthful Intelligence will consist of irreversible bodhisattva great beings as numerous as the grains of sand of the river Ganges. The second gathering will

consist of eighty niyutas of bodhisattvas bound to one more birth. The third gathering will consist of sixty kaṅkaras of bodhisattvas. After that he will establish sentient beings beyond number and counting in irreversibility from unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening.

"Mañjuśrī, the lifespan of that tathāgata King of the Crest of Truthful Intelligence, once he has attained awakening, will be sixty intermediate eons. After his final nirvāṇa, the true Dharma will remain for eighty hundred thousand koṭis of niyutas of years. Through the spread of the true Dharma, that many sentient beings will be tamed.

"Mañjuśrī, when that tathāgata is about to pass into final nirvāṇa, he will prophesy the bodhisattva called Mahāketu, saying, 'After me this one will fully awaken to unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening, and will become the tathāgata, arhat, perfectly and completely awakened buddha called Mahāvyūha,' and then he will pass into final nirvāṇa."

Then at that time the entire assembly wondered, "Who is the bodhisattva called Mahāketu who will appear at that time, on that occasion, and after that Blessed One, the tathāgata King of the Crest of Truthful Intelligence, will fully awaken to unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening and become the tathāgata, arhat, perfectly and completely awakened buddha called Mahāvyūha?"

Then the Blessed One, knowing with his mind the thoughts in the minds of that entire assembly, said to Mañjuśrī Kumārabhūta, "Mañjuśrī, son of noble family, this brahmin youth called Delighting in Truth, who is seated before Satyavādin and is the foremost among all the brahmin boys, will at that time, on that occasion, become the tathāgata, arhat, perfectly and completely awakened buddha called Mahāvyūha. The arrays of his buddha field will be just like the arrays of the buddha field of the tathāgata King of the Crest of Truthful Intelligence."

When they heard of the greatness of that buddha field's array of qualities, six million koṭis of niyutas of bodhisattvas from that assembly made the aspiration to be born in that buddha field, saying, "When the Blessed One, the tathāgata King of the Crest of Truthful Intelligence, fully awakens to unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening, may we too be born in that world realm!" Then the Blessed One prophesied that all of them would be born in that buddha field.

Then those eight hundred thousand Nirgranthas also spoke with one voice and made the aspiration, "Blessed One, may we too be born in that buddha field!" Then the Blessed One prophesied that they too would be born in that buddha field.

Then from the sky above, nine million koṭis of niyutas of gods also spoke these words and made the aspiration, "Blessed One, may we too be born in that buddha field where the Blessed One, the tathāgata King of the Crest of Truthful Intelligence, attains awakening, the world realm Renowned as Well Beheld! May we see its inconceivable array of qualities!"

The Blessed One declared, "Gods, you too will be born in that world realm Renowned as Well Beheld, and you will please that tathāgata. And you gods will also fully awaken to unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening in that very world realm Renowned as Well Beheld. You will become tathāgatas of different names, but your lifespans will be the same."

Then at that moment this great trichiliocosm, this world realm of a billion worlds, shook in six ways. From beneath the earth many hundreds of thousands of koṭis of niyutas of lotuses broke through the ground and rose up. They had petals of Jambū river gold, clusters of stamens of the great precious sapphire, the indranīla, cores of musāragalva, and stalks of precious beryl. On every one of those lotuses there appeared the form of a bodhisattva seated cross-legged, his body beautifully adorned with the excellent major and minor marks, bowing and paying homage to the Blessed One. They covered the Blessed One with canopies of clouds of various jewels and spoke these words: "Blessed One, we have come here from various other world realms to listen to this teaching on the inconceivable qualities of bodhisattvas that the Tathāgata has given, to behold the Blessed One, to pay homage and to honor him, and also to see this son of noble family Satyavādin and this gathered assembly. Blessed One, through hearing this Dharma discourse, countless bodhisattvas in inconceivable buddha fields have become irreversible from unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening."

Then, at that time, in order to make this very point fully clear, the Blessed One spoke these verses:

"With one-pointed mind, settle your senses evenly,
And listen to the meaning of what I say today.
The Tathāgata has no words of falsehood;
The words of the Sugata, the Self-Arisen, are never otherwise.

This very Satyavādin, who brings joy to beings,
In a kalpa pure, stainless and free of harm,
After many countless kalpas, in the world
Will awaken as King of the Crest of Truthful Intelligence.

The harm of the afflictions will not arise there;
Therefore that kalpa will be called Free of Harm.
The world, too, will be named Well Beheld,
And that kalpa will become a mass of splendor.

That kalpa of that Guide
Will be worthy to be gazed upon by gods and humans.
Its moats and bathing steps of heaped jewels
Will be delightful, utterly beautiful on every side.

It will be covered with nets of Jambū river gold,
Resounding with the lovely sound of Dharma.
Excellent lion banners will always be raised,
And hundreds of tassels of heaped jewels will hang down.

Its rows of walls will be of stainless jewels,
So that it will be like a dwelling of the gods.
With ponds, springs and lotus lakes
It will always be beautifully adorned.

Its waters will be covered all over
With lotuses, blue lotuses and white lotuses.
The world of four continents at its center
Will be named Lovely to Behold and Delightful.

That will be the birthplace of that Sugata;
That Self-Arisen One will be born in a brahmin family.
The Sage's mother will be called Endowed with Vigor,
And his father will be called Treasure of Brahmā.

His son will be called Sound of Wide Renown,
Just like this son of mine, Rāhula.
The noble consort of that Sugata
Will be Great Intelligence, just like my Gopā.

His nurse will be named Great Renown,
Just like my Mahāprajāpatī.
The noble being who will attend the Sage

Will be called Ever Following;
Just like my devoted attendant Chandaka,
He will serve that Guide.

The supreme horse of that Sage
Will bear the name Mighty;
When the Sugata goes forth, he will ride it,
Just as with my supreme horse Kanthaka.

That Sugata's tree of perfect awakening
Will then arise, called Noble Dharma.
Supreme trees, by hundreds of thousands
Multiplied eightyfold, will encircle it.

Oh, at the foot of that supreme tree, the King of Dharma,
The Self-Arisen, the Peerless One, called Truthful, will sit,
And he will fully awaken to unsurpassed awakening,
Perfectly peaceful and free of sorrow.

There will be no māras there, nor any of Māra's faction,
Nor will the deeds of Māra occur there.
The buddha field of the Victor, the Sage, the peerless person,
Will be free of harm and of strife.

Many hosts of humans and gods will gather;
Then they will become utterly pure and thoroughly cleansed.
All of them, with flowers, garlands, robes, songs
And the sound of music, will go before the Sugata.

The Victor, knowing their thoughts, the Sage
Will teach this sūtra together with other sūtras.
Hearing this most excellent sūtra
Proclaimed by that Victor,
Immeasurable beings, as many as the Ganges' sands,
Will become irreversible from the supreme awakening of the Lord of Sages.

The Lesser Vehicle will not arise there,
Nor will the vehicle of the solitary buddhas arise in that field.
In that supreme buddha field of that Victor,
All the bodhisattvas who arise will be heroic and wise.

In the first assembly of that Supreme Among Humans,
The sons of the Victor, radiant with renown,
Bodhisattvas perfected and irreversible,
Pure, more numerous than the Ganges' grains of dust, will gather.

In the second assembly of those with excellent minds,
Eighty niyutas bound to one more birth will gather.
In the third assembly, supreme bodhisattvas
Numbering sixty great multitudes will gather.

The lifespan of that Sugata
Will be a full sixty intermediate kalpas.
After that Victor has passed into nirvāṇa,
The lamp of Dharma of that Guide of Humans
Will remain for exactly eighty thousand
Koṭis of niyutas of years.

His own bodily relics will spread far and wide,
And they will tame a great many to be trained.
That great sage, having prophesied
The bodhisattva Mahāketu, will pass into nirvāṇa.

This one will become the Lord of Sages called Mahāvyūha;
He will become a Victor, victorious over foes.
The array of that Victor's field will be like this,
And so will he act for the benefit of the world.

He will attain the Victor's awakening, matchless and stainless,
And become a protector, a perfect buddha, utterly at peace.
My knowledge is like that, vast as the sky;
I know full well the many kalpas that will come.
Since I know the past by its years, what need to think about the present?
I possess wisdom unobstructed in every respect.

My words are pure and without falsehood;
I do not speak falsely. Abiding in the ultimate truth,
I never speak otherwise.
Have faith in what has been said here."

Having heard these words of the great sage,
All the assembly were filled with joy,
And, saying, "May we be born in that realm at that time,"

They made the aspiration, with faith, to be born in that supreme field.

"You will be born in that supreme world realm,"
So the Guide of the World prophesied to them.
"There, having attained the state of a sugata,
All of you will bring great benefit to beings."

When this king of sūtras was taught,
This great earth too shook in six ways.
Then the bodhisattvas who were seated on the lotuses
Joined their palms and said this to the Sage:

"You have taught this sublime way of Dharma,
Peerless Sage, excellent by its very nature.
To listen to this sublime way of Dharma
And to seek the Dharma of the Victor, we have come here."

Then that entire assembly, satisfied and delighted, overjoyed and utterly glad, with joy and happiness born in them, each laid down an upper robe, and placing other robes upon the body of the Blessed One, they also spoke these words: "Oh! A second turning of the wheel of Dharma has taken place in the world! The first was turned in the city of Vārāṇasī. The second wheel of Dharma the Blessed One has turned here today." And they made the aspiration, "Blessed One, may we too always, without interruption, never be parted from such a precious Dharma as this, and never be parted from this holy being!"

From the sky above, great divine drums also resounded.

A great rain of divine flowers, blue lotuses, lotuses, white water lilies and white lotuses also fell at the feet of the Blessed One. In the sky above, the gods waved divine robes about as fans, and they also spoke these words: "Those holy beings who hold, recite and master this Dharma discourse are endowed with inconceivable qualities."

When they had said this, Mañjuśrī Kumārabhūta said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, when any son or daughter of noble family holds, recites and masters this Dharma discourse, teaches it extensively to others as well, and makes it into a book and keeps it, how great a mass of merit will increase?"

When he had asked this, the Blessed One said to Mañjuśrī Kumārabhūta, "Mañjuśrī, suppose that all the beings in this great trichiliocosm, this world

realm of a billion worlds, whether with form or without form, with perception or without perception, as many beings as the wisdom of the buddhas knows to exist in the realm of beings, all of them at once, none before or after, were to obtain a human body and fully awaken to unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening. And suppose that some son or daughter of noble family were to serve all of them, for as long as they remained, for a kalpa, with every article of comfort, treating them as teachers, honoring them and making offerings to them. Mañjuśrī, what do you think? Would that son or daughter of noble family generate much merit?"

He replied, "Much, Blessed One. Much, Sugata. It would not be easy even to count or reckon it."

The Blessed One said, "Mañjuśrī, whoever holds this Dharma discourse, or recites it, or also teaches it correctly and extensively to others, or writes it in a book and keeps it, or, having taught it correctly and extensively to others, gives the transmission of this Dharma discourse, will generate even more merit than that."

When he had said this, Mañjuśrī Kumārabhūta said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, it is wonderful that the Tathāgata has taught this Dharma discourse for the benefit of the whole world. Blessed One, for how long will this Dharma discourse remain in Jambudvīpa?"

The Blessed One said, "Mañjuśrī, after I have passed into nirvāṇa, eight kings, in order to spread my relics far and wide, will divide them into eight portions, place them in eight caskets, and each will install them in a spacious stupa house in his own country. King Ajātaśatru will take one eighth of my relics, place it in a jeweled casket, dig into the ground outside the great city of Rājagṛha, and seal the relics in a vessel with a covering lid. He will perfume it with incense, set up parasols and banners, scatter jewel flowers, light a lamp blessed to burn for a hundred years with a single unwavering flame, and so lay the relic casket to rest. And in anticipation of King Aśoka, who is to appear, he will write this king of sūtras on a golden book and place it in that same relic casket.

"Mañjuśrī, King Aśoka will appear when a hundred years have passed after my nirvāṇa. He will be born into the Maurya clan, will rule over Jambudvīpa, will possess might and vigor, and will be a universal monarch through force of arms. He will recollect me through my image, and he will gain faith in my teaching. At that time, on that occasion, there will appear a monk called

Blissful Lord, of great miraculous power and great might, who upholds the sacred Dharma, holds the most extensive sūtras, has gone forth from a royal family, and, honored by King Aśoka, enters the city.

"Mañjuśrī, in this way, in order to spread my relics far and wide, King Aśoka, surrounded by a great many people, with great pomp and great royal might, bearing flowers, garlands, incense, powders, ointments, cymbals and drums, will go to the great city of Rājagṛha. Having performed a great ceremony of worship, he will take that relic casket out from that place in the ground. For seven days he will make many kinds of offerings with every kind of incense, every kind of flower, every kind of garland, every kind of powder, every kind of ointment, every kind of cymbal, the beating of drums, and every kind of song and melody. Then, at a single moment endowed with the right constellation and conjunction, he will build in various lands eighty-four thousand stupas made by a king of Dharma.

"At that time the Dharma preacher Blissful Lord will take this Dharma discourse out of the relic casket and set it down in the great land of the northern region. Many people will not know it, many people will not understand it, many people will not take it up; those who hold this Dharma discourse will be few, and those who recite it will be few. Mañjuśrī, this Dharma discourse will always be kept shut in a box and stored in a container. Why is that? Because there will be no one seeking the Dharma, and they will not be fit vessels. Mañjuśrī, this Dharma discourse is hard to be inspired by, hard to believe and hard to realize; those in darkness cannot believe in it or enter into it.

"Mañjuśrī, in the later time, in the future age, when the last five hundred years have come, if any people hear this Dharma discourse and come to believe in it, or seek it, or reflect on it, then, Mañjuśrī, you should know with certainty that they have served many buddhas, have practiced excellent conduct, and have become vessels for this Great Vehicle. All those sons or daughters of noble family who hold, keep, recite and master this Dharma discourse, and make it into a book and keep it, will think, 'In the past we saw tathāgatas as numerous as the sands of the Ganges river,

we pleased them, and we served them.' And it should be understood that they also saw me teaching this Dharma discourse in this park, and saw this gathered assembly."

Then the Blessed One said to the venerable Ānanda, "Ānanda, take up this Dharma discourse! Hold it! Master it! Apart from those of sharp faculties, do not teach it before just anyone. Why is that? Because, Ānanda, this is the secret of the Tathāgata; this is the great secret of the Tathāgata; this is the Tathāgata's teaching of the Dharma without interruption; this is the seal of the Tathāgata; this is the cultivation of the Tathāgata's protection; and this is the supreme treasure of the Tathāgata. Therefore, Ānanda, apart from giving it to my eldest sons, who hold the treasury of the Dharma and guard the treasury of the Dharma, this should be kept well hidden and should not be given to anyone."

Ānanda said, "Blessed One, I have taken up this Dharma discourse. Blessed One, what is the name of this Dharma discourse? How should I hold it?"

The Blessed One said, "Therefore, Ānanda, hold this Dharma discourse as The Teaching on the Miraculous Display in the Domain of Skillful Means within the Sphere of Activity of Bodhisattvas. Hold it also as The Secret Abode of the Tathāgata, as The Tathāgata's Teaching of the Dharma without Interruption, as The Domain of the Tathāgata, as The Teaching of the Single Vehicle, as The Questions of Mañjuśrī, as The Prophecy of Satyavādin, and as The Chapter of Satyavādin."

When this Dharma discourse was taught, thirty niyutas of living beings who had not previously given rise to the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening gave rise to that mind. Sixty thousand bodhisattvas attained acceptance of the nonarising of phenomena. Immeasurable beings became destined for unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening.

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, the venerable Ānanda, Mañjuśrī Kumārabhūta, all those bodhisattvas, and the entire assembly of monks, nuns, laymen and laywomen, together with Śakra, Brahmā, the world guardians, and the world with its gods, humans, asuras and gandharvas, rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

This concludes the tenth chapter, on the prophecy.

This concludes the noble Great Vehicle sūtra called The Teaching on the Miraculous Display in the Domain of Skillful Means within the Sphere of Activity of Bodhisattvas.

It was translated, edited and finalized by the Indian preceptor Prajñāvarman and the chief editor-translator, the monk Yeshé Dé, and others.

Translator's Notes

• Most of the bodhisattva names in the long list are rendered by meaning into English, since their Sanskrit originals cannot be identified with confidence; only the well-established ones are given in Sanskrit. The bird called "wing-guard" ('dab skyob) and the tree "dhanukari" could not be identified with certainty and are given literally or as transliterated. "They had liberated their bodies and sentient beings" follows the Tibetan as it stands; the sense may be that they were liberated in body and in mind.
• "Of great splendor, of great splendor, of great vastness, of great vastness" reproduces the Tibetan's doubled epithets, which likely render a Sanskrit distributive repetition meaning "each of great splendor and great might." The jewel worn by Śakra (brgya byin thogs pa) is rendered by its usual Sanskrit name, Śakrābhilagna.
• "The analytical knowledges" renders so so rig (pratisaṃvid), the four discriminating knowledges of a bodhisattva.
• The image of guarding discipline "as the yak guards its tail" (gyag rnga bzhin) alludes to the yak (camarī) that will risk its life rather than let its tail be caught or damaged, a stock image for protecting moral discipline. In the first verse, "marrow" renders the second rkang, following its sense beside "bones."
• "Vigor" renders □□□□□□, an uncommon term here apparently meaning energetic resolve or exertion (perhaps Skt. utsāha). "The aspect of freedom at will, because one turns back from the meditative concentrations" (□□□□□□□□□□, □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□) refers to the bodhisattva's ability to withdraw from the concentrations at will rather than being reborn through them. "Children of the Sage" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, the Sage being the Buddha.
• In the verse on turning back from the concentrations, the Tibetan reads "not wishing to be born in the desire realm" (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□); the doctrinal point elsewhere is usually that bodhisattvas turn back from the concentrations so as not to be reborn in the higher realms, so this line may be corrupt, but it is translated as written. The last verse on wisdom compares the bodhisattvas' minds to Tārā's (□□□□□□□, "the Savioress"); the sense of the comparison is not fully clear. "The Moon of Sages" (□□□□□□□□□□□) is an epithet of the Buddha.
• In the second verse the line □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is a syllable short and □□□ makes no sense; it is read as □□□□□□□, "appear in the waters [of saṃsāra]," which fits the image of bathing in the lake of nirvāṇa. "Degeneration" renders □□□□□□□ (kaṣāya), the classic five degenerations. "The closed fist of a teacher" is the stock image of a teacher who withholds part of the Dharma. Mañjuśrī's question continues in the next piece.
• "Sapphire" renders □□□□□□□□□ (Skt. indranīla). "Abide at a single ford" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□; the point seems to be that the apparent non-Buddhist teachers (tīrthikas, "ford-makers") are in fact children of good family abiding at the one ford of the Tathāgata's teaching.
• "Essence" (□□□□) in the verses picks up the "essences" (□□□□□□□□) of the eon, the times, and the field in the prose of the previous chapter, and contrasts with the five degenerations. "As though remains were left behind" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, which may refer either to relics left after the Buddha's passing or to nirvāṇa "with remainder"; the former seems likelier.
• The Nirgrantha protagonist (Tibetan "the son of the Naked Ones, Speaker of Truth") is the figure known in Chinese sources as Mahāsatya Nirgranthaputra; the Tibetan name is rendered Satyavādin here. The verse "all these who come by the door of the tīrthikas" refers to bodhisattvas who appear in the guise of non-Buddhist teachers, as the following chapters show. "Grew radiant" renders a verb meaning literally "became white", i.e. brightened with joy.
• Several of the occupations in the opening list are uncertain: "players" renders a word for musicians or performers, "brigands of the mountain passes" a word for those who lie in wait at passes, and "goatherds" and "rat-catchers" are tentative literal renderings of two terms whose

exact sense here is unclear. "Let your speech be abundant" follows the Tibetan as it stands; a sense such as "speak truthfully" might be expected.
• The closing gloss plays on the Sanskrit etymology of rājan, "king", from rāj, "to shine": a king is so called because he shines by delighting his subjects. "Lord of creatures" in the verses is an epithet of the king (echoing Prajāpati), not the god Prajāpati himself. "Observe the fast-day vows" renders the observance of the upavāsa (poṣadha).
• "A treatise on worldly aims" renders a term corresponding to the Sanskrit arthaśāstra, the genre of statecraft manuals; the passage contrasts such works, composed in the degenerate age, with the treatises of the great sages.
• "In keeping with what was agreed" renders a phrase about abiding by what has been accepted or pledged; it is not wholly clear whether the king's own commitment or a legal agreement is meant. "Restriction" renders a term whose exact sense is uncertain.
• Here □□□ (rgyal po'i khams) means a king's realm, not "element," and □□□□ means punishment, not "annihilation"; the glossary senses do not apply in this context. The clause □□□□

certain. The verse line rgyal pos rtag tu shes gus brtson is terse and its exact sense is uncertain.

• □□□□□□□□□ here is the name of a prince, so it is given as Mahādeva rather than as the god Śiva. The reconstructions Vasudeva (□□□□□□) and Mahāsena (□□□□□□□) are probable but not attested here. The verse line □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is terse; it is read as the procrastinator losing what timely action would have yielded.

• The phrase ngor ro bar smra ba, read here as speaking "far too bluntly," is uncommon and its exact nuance is uncertain. In this passage □□□□□ means family lineage, not tantra.

• This list of thirty-two marks differs from the usual one: it has no crown protuberance (uṣṇīṣa) and lists blue hair, forty teeth, close-fitting teeth, even teeth, and white teeth as separate marks; it is translated as it stands. Six years on "a juniper berry" renders rgya shug as written, though parallels usually speak of a jujube.

• The prose counts "thirty" marks before the crown protuberance, apparently treating the protuberance and the Dharma conch as the remaining two; this is kept as written. The verse phrase rkyen du 'bab, describing the Buddha's body, is obscure and is rendered loosely as "finely shaped."

• The word rendered "lips" (sgros) is not the usual term; the parallel lists of minor marks have lips red like the bimba fruit, and that sense is followed here. The animal named in "a majestic gait like an elephant" (bal glang) can also mean an ox; "elephant" follows the standard list of gaits (elephant, lion, bull, goose). Several marks in this verse list are tersely worded and do not follow the familiar Mahāvyutpatti order; they are rendered as this text gives them.

• "Tormented by old age and death" renders rga shi, the standard compound for old age and death. The simile of the tangled weave, the knotted ball of thread, and muñja and balbaja grass is the stock image for beings hopelessly entangled.

• In the line "Blissful, unshakable, and free of all fear," the Tibetan reads literally "free of fear and whatever"; the second word may be a slip, and the general sense "free of fear and every ill" is given. "Through the bases of miraculous power" renders a phrase that literally speaks of the bases (literally "feet") of miraculous power being "even" or "balanced."

• In the formula of the fearlessnesses the Tibetan has "challenge me" (the Buddha's own standpoint carried over from the canonical first-person formula); it is rendered "challenge him" to fit Satyavādin's third-person report.

• "In seeing the faculties" renders dbang po gzigs pa, which is terse and may instead mean the Lord's vision; "in honor of the Dharma" renders chos kyi dgab pa, literally "as a covering of the Dharma." The final speech of Satyavādin continues into the next piece.

• The faith called "Domain of the Force of Joy" and the absorption called "Array of the Buddha's Ornaments" are translated from the Tibetan; their Sanskrit forms are not attested with confidence. The musical instruments ki ma pa la and na ku la are given as transliterated names (nakula is known as a stringed instrument; kimapala is unidentified); □□□□□□□□ is taken as gongs or bell-metal percussion and □□□ as a kind of drum. "Clothe him with the Dharma" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, an honorific gesture of offering their garments. Śāriputra and Śāradvatīputra are both used here, as in the Tibetan, for the same elder.

• "Looked upon" renders the repeated □□□, distinguished here from □□□□ "see". The long series beginning "in no way seeing him" is a run of qualifiers modifying how the Tathāgata is looked upon; it is rendered as one sentence to keep its structure. □□□□□□ is taken in its sense of "destiny of rebirth" (gati), which the following discussion of birth, death and transmigration confirms; □□□□□□□ is rendered "bound/binding" in that sense.

• □□□ and □□□□□□□□□□□□ are paired here as "meaning" and "ascertainment" (artha and its definitive exposition); the passage then maps them onto the four analytical knowledges (pratisaṃvid). □□□□□□□ and □□□□□□□□□□□ are taken as two classes of Indian ascetics, probably caraka and parivrājaka, rendered "wandering ascetic" and "mendicant".

□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is the coemergent (personal guardian) deity said to be born together with each person. □□□□□□□□ is read as "waves" (agitation).
• The names of the future eon (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□), the world system (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□) and the future buddha (□□□) cannot be identified with confidence in Sanskrit and are translated by meaning. The jewel names (Lovely Lion, Lion Banner, Banner of Light, Banner of the Crest) are likewise translated. Architectural terms (rab "ramparts", rta babs "gateways", pu shu "parapets", mkha' rten "turrets") follow their usual sense in such descriptions of buddha-fields.
• The names of the four-continent world (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, "Pleasing Even at a Glance", a tentative reading), the future buddha's mother, father, son, nurse, attendant, horse and seat of awakening are translated by meaning, as their Sanskrit forms cannot be identified with confidence. □□□□□□□□ is Gopā, the Buddha's wife in many Mahāyāna sources. The large numbers □□□□□□□□□ and □□□□□□□ are rendered niyuta and kaṅkara, following their usual Sanskrit equivalents; their exact values vary between systems. The Dharma discourse named is the title of this very sūtra.
• The brahmin youth's name, Tibetan bden dga', is rendered by its meaning, "Delighting in Truth," since its Sanskrit original (perhaps Satyarati or similar) cannot be identified with confidence. The numbers follow the Tibetan: "sixty hundred thousand" koṭis of niyutas (six million), eight hundred thousand Nirgranthas, and "ninety hundred thousand" koṭis of niyutas of gods (nine million).
• Several names in the verses are rendered by meaning because their Sanskrit forms cannot be identified with confidence: the mother "Endowed with Vigor," the son "Sound of Wide Renown," the consort "Great Intelligence," the nurse "Great Renown," the attendant "Ever Following," the horse "Mighty," the bodhi tree "Noble Dharma," the world "Lovely to Behold and Delightful," and the kalpa "Free of Harm." The lines on the trees surrounding the bodhi tree ("hundreds of thousands ... eighty") are ambiguous; they are rendered as eighty times a hundred thousand. In the third assembly, dkrigs is a very large Tibetan numeral; it is rendered as "great multitudes." The line about Satyavādin "who brings joy to beings" reads skye bo de dga'; it is taken as an epithet of Satyavādin, not a separate name.
• The monk's name, dbang po bde ba, is rendered by meaning as "Blissful Lord," since its Sanskrit form cannot be identified with confidence. The phrase mun sprul, describing those who cannot believe or enter the teaching, is obscure; it is rendered "those in darkness." The piece ends in mid-sentence; the quoted thought of the devotees continues in the next piece.
• The final chapter is numbered tenth in the Tibetan, although the list of chapter endings has no ninth; this follows the text as it stands.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.